🗺️ AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Cartographers

Recon, OSINT & Attack-Surface Mapping Tools

40	309,659	88%	29
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

Intro: Map the terrain before you move — subdomain, content and OSINT discovery for bug bounty and asset management.

Deep-research edition. Every entry re-verified and enriched with live GitHub statistics (stars, first release, last push, license, language) pulled 2026-10-20 via the GitHub API, plus per-realm field intelligence. Tool profiles rank the realm's most-adopted projects and note who uses each tool and the commercial product it replaces; the full inventory keeps every curated entry.

Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — **449 curated free tools across 14 realms**.

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven
CC0 · 2026-10-20

01 Realm Intelligence

live GitHub census · 2026-10-20

40	35	309,659	29	3,691	2010
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Intro: Map the terrain before you move — subdomain, content and OSINT discovery for bug bounty and asset management.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE (AI-ASSISTED)

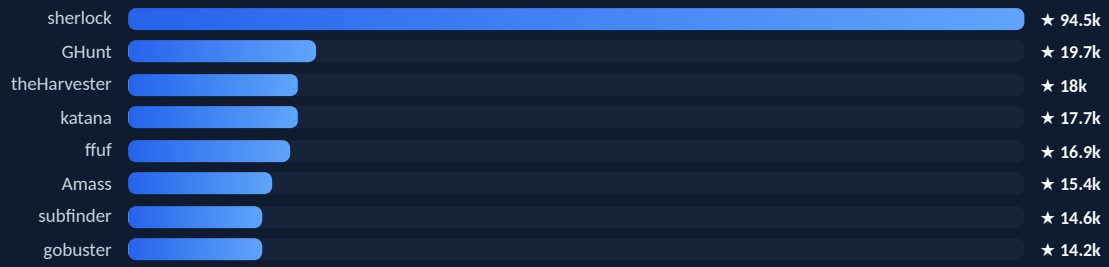
This Cartographers recon, OSINT, and attack-surface mapping tool realm shows strong overall maturity, with its oldest curated entry dating to December 16, 2010, and 88% of the 40 total curated tools hosted on public GitHub repositories. Adoption is heavily concentrated among the highest-starred tools, as the top five entries by combined GitHub stars — sherlock, GHunt, theHarvester, katana, and ffuf — account for a substantial share of the realm's total 309,659 cumulative stars, far outpacing the median tool star count of 3,691. The 29 tools that received code pushes in 2026 indicate consistent, active maintenance across most of the curated set, with only a small subset of quiet classics including dnstwist, assetfinder, VHostScan, and ike-scan seeing no recent development activity. A key notable trend is the overwhelming language concentration in Python and Go, which together power 30 of the 40 curated tools, while MIT licensing dominates the license mix at 16 entries, reflecting the open, permissive development norms of this tool category.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-lite over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-20. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

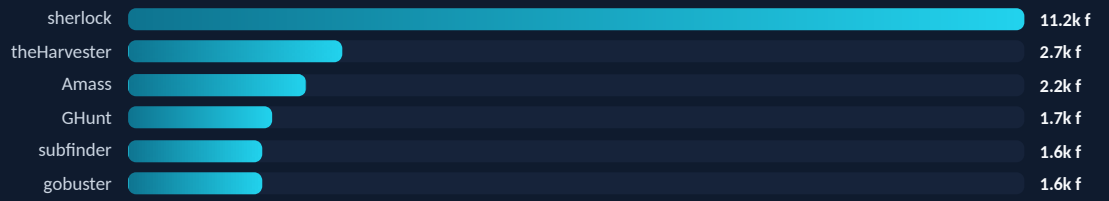
01 The Adoption Map

who the community actually stars

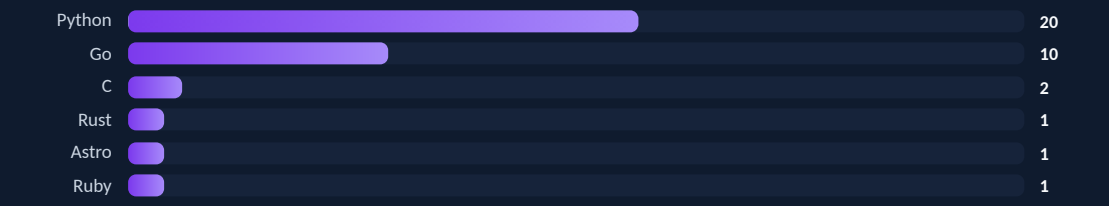
TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST-FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



LANGUAGE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



01 Generations & Momentum

the realm's age structure

THE FOUNDERS — OLDEST TRACKED ENTRIES

dnsrecon	2010-12-16
theHarvester	2011-01-01
ike-scan	2013-08-15
Recog	2013-12-26
EyeWitness	2014-02-26

THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST GITHUB ARRIVALS

AtDork	2026-06
DorkCraft	2026-05
DorkEye	2025-05
CloakQuest3r	2023-11
Awesome Censys Queries	2022-08

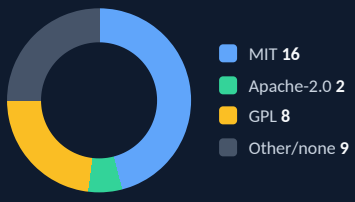
CREATION ERAS — WHEN THE REALM WAS BUILT

2008-2012	2013-2016	2017-2020	2021-2026
2	7	18	8

QUIET CLASSICS (NO 2026 PUSH, STILL THE STANDARD)

dnstwist, assetfinder, VHostScan, ike-scan, JA3, HASSH

LICENSE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



02 Tool Profiles — the heavyweights

full-page dossiers · ranked by adoption

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, **who uses it and which commercial product it replaces**, and its star weight against the realm's #1.

Profiles are ordered by GitHub adoption (stars). Non-GitHub entries follow, alphabetically. Flagship marks the realm's top 8 by stars.

01 sherlock

github.com/sherlock-project/sherlock

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 94.5k	GITHUB STARS
11,201	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Hunt down social media accounts by username across social networks"

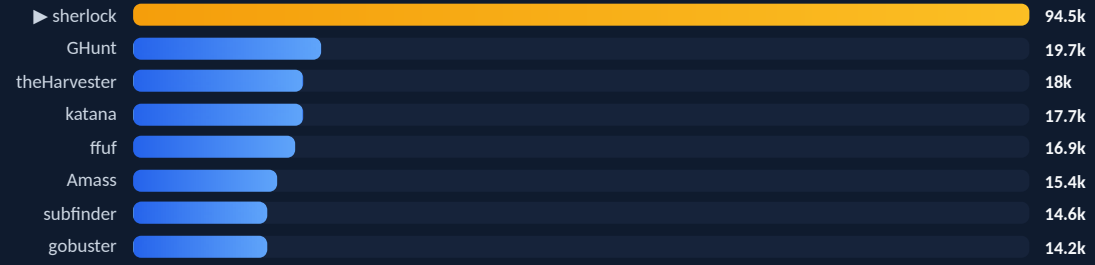
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

hunt one username across 400+ social networks; people-OSINT in seconds.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by OSINT investigators checking username presence across hundreds of platforms; the standard free account-discovery tool.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



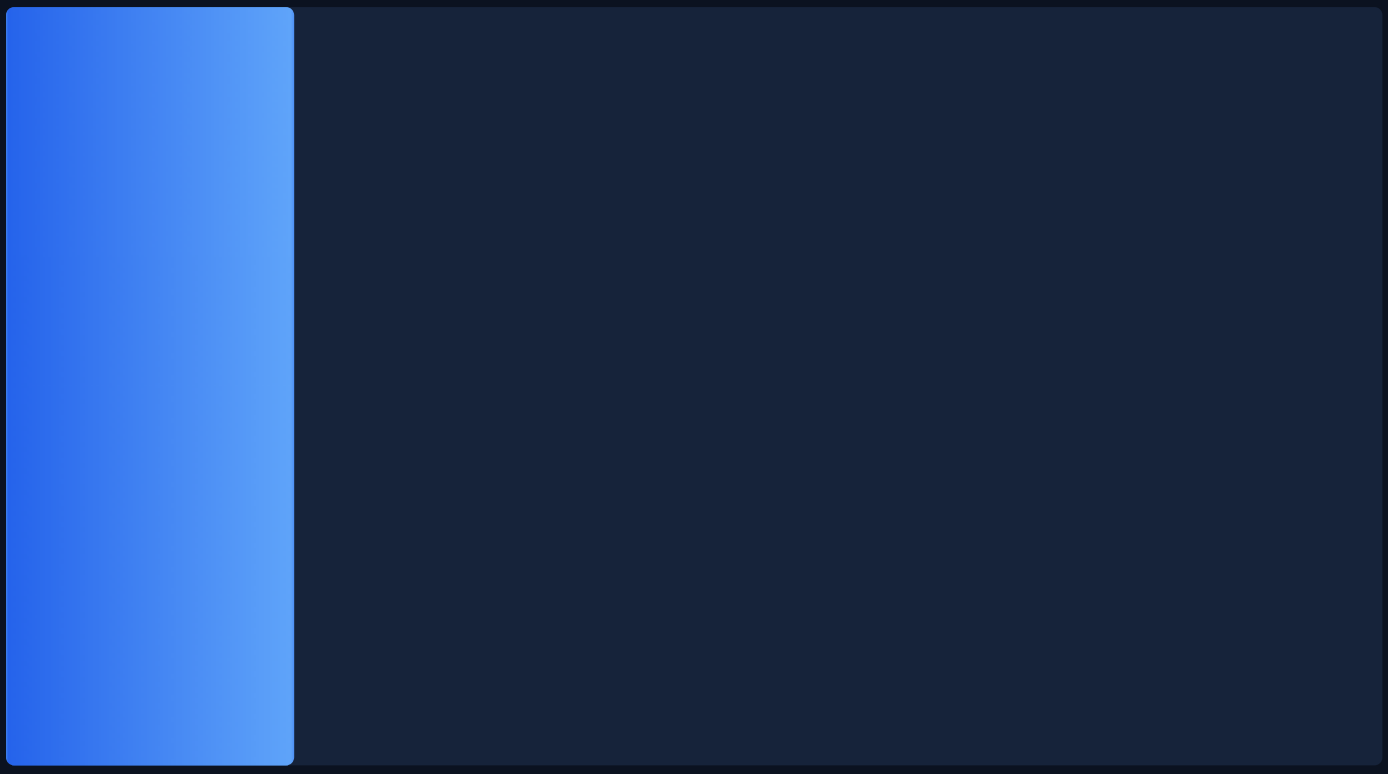
8	11,201	350	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

02 GHunt

github.com/mxrch/GHunt

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 19.7k	GITHUB STARS
1,738	FORKS
2026-04	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"🕵️ Offensive Google framework."

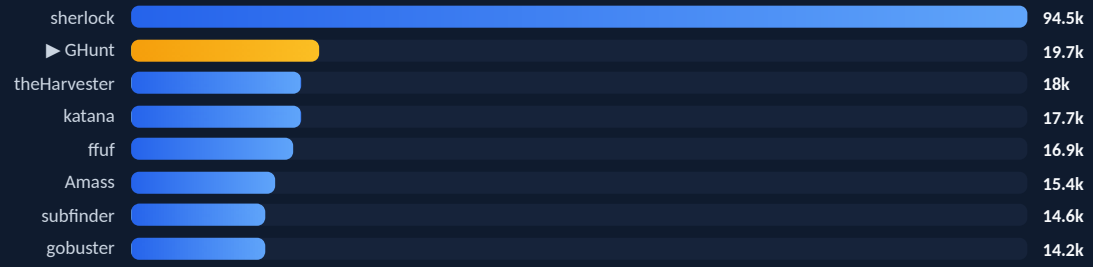
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

investigate a Google account's public footprint (photos, reviews, services) from an email — for authorized OSINT; respect ToS.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by OSINT investigators profiling Google accounts from public artifacts; the open alternative to commercial people-intel tools.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



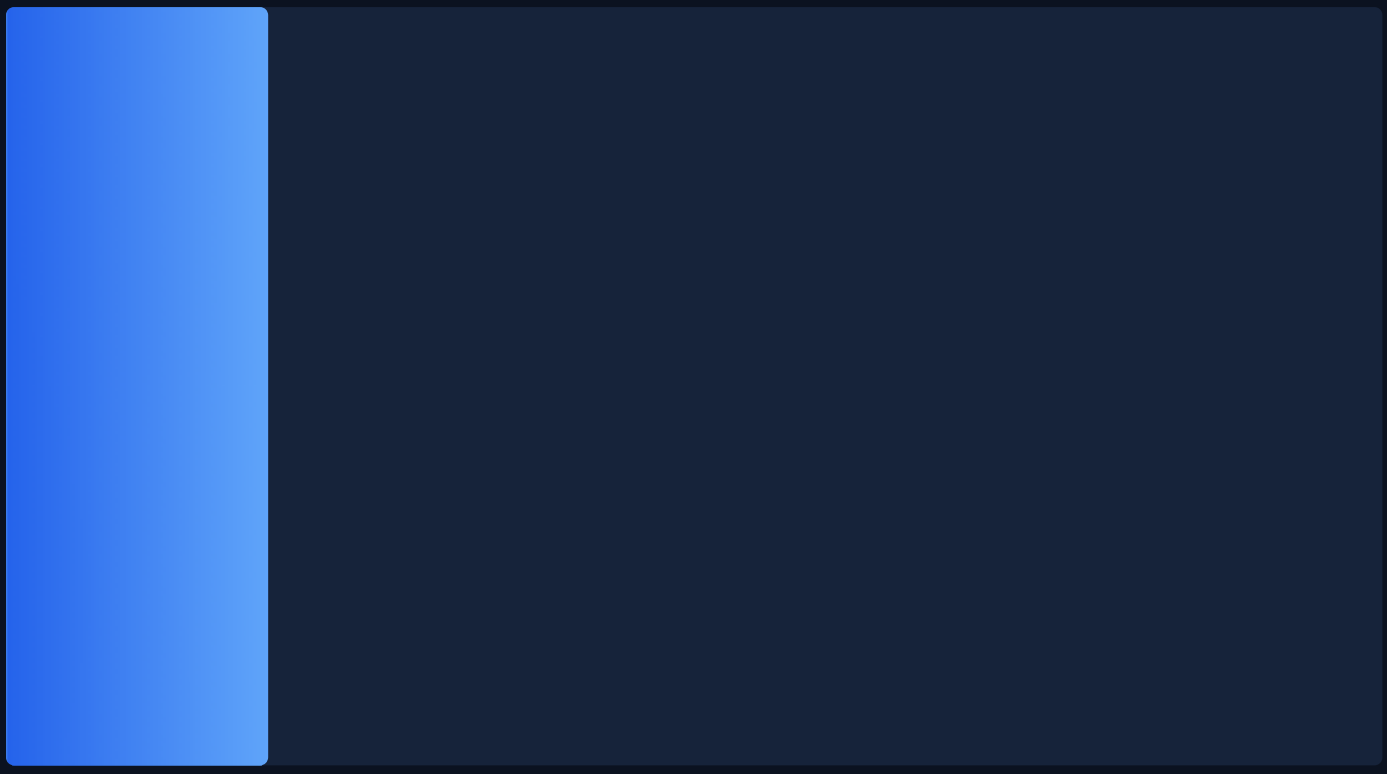
6	1,738	80	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

03 theHarvester

github.com/laramies/theHarvester

★ FLAGSHIP PICK · ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 18k	GITHUB STARS
2,671	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2011	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"E-mails, subdomains and names Harvester - OSINT"

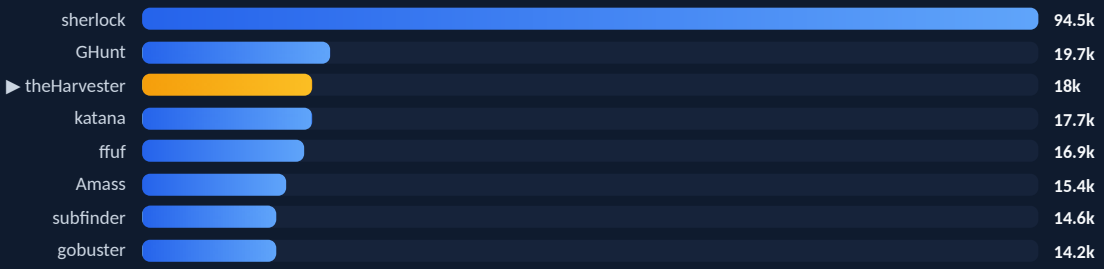
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

emails, subdomains, hosts and names from public sources — the OSINT starter kit.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters in the recon phase harvesting emails, names and subdomains; the veteran free OSINT gatherer.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



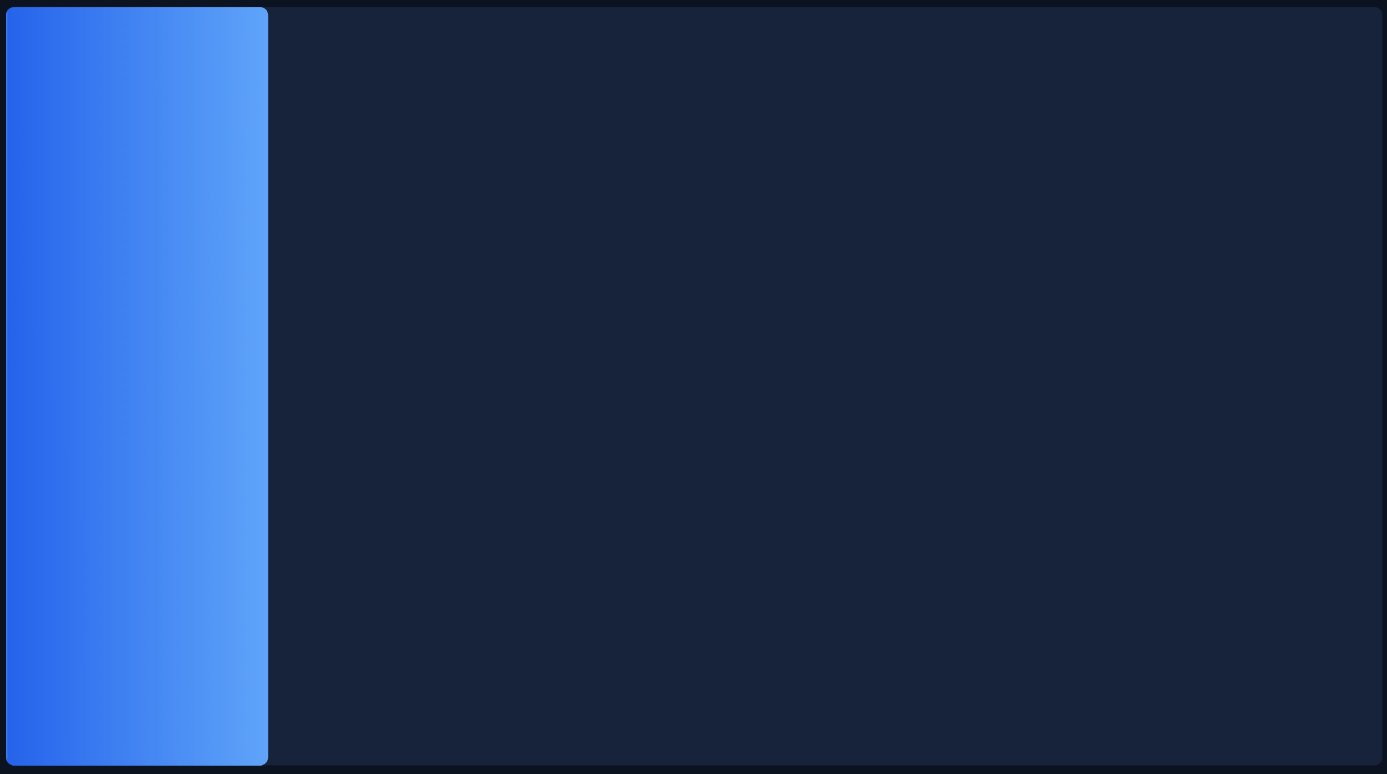
15	2,671	11	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

04 katana

github.com/projectdiscovery/katana

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 17.7k	GITHUB STARS
1,292	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2021	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A next-generation crawling and spidering framework."

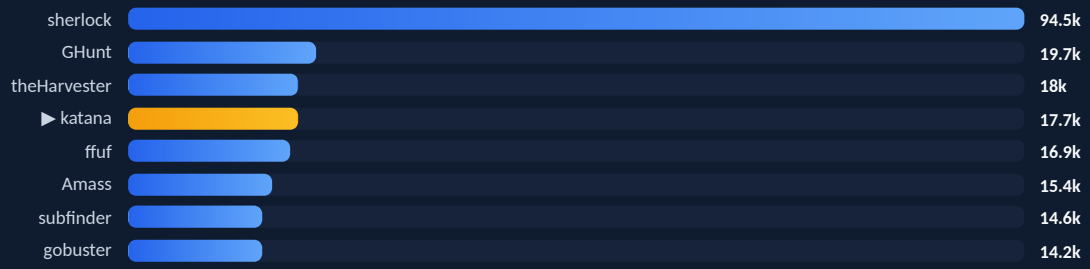
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

next-generation crawler with headless-browser support for JavaScript-heavy applications.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug hunters and pentesters crawling modern JS-heavy apps; the ProjectDiscovery successor to legacy crawlers in recon pipelines.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



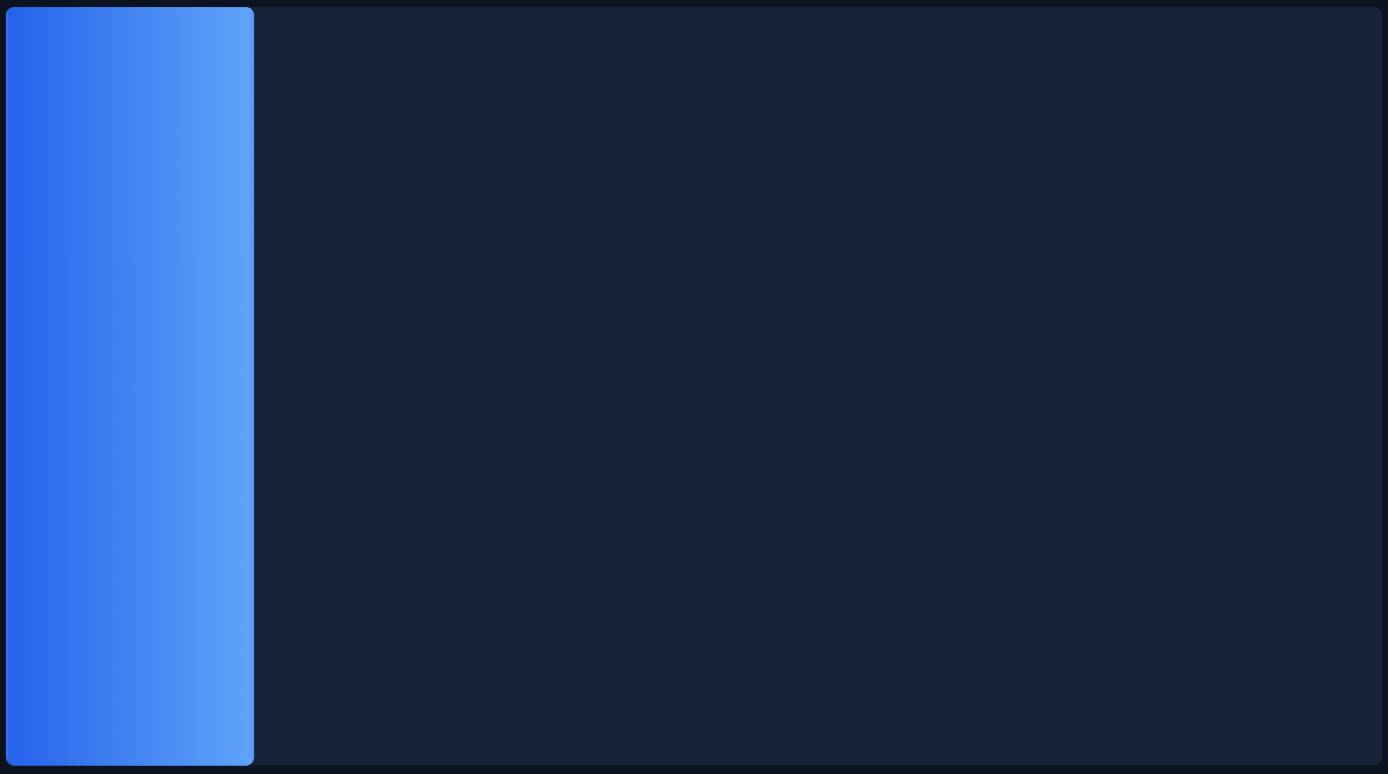
5	1,292	25	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

05 ffuf

github.com/ffuf/ffuf

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 16.9k	GITHUB STARS
1,622	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Fast web fuzzer written in Go"

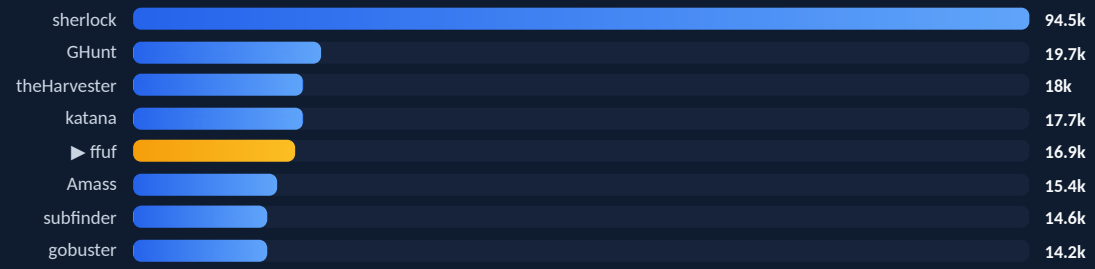
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the fast web fuzzer everyone uses for content, parameter and vhost discovery.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by web pentesters as the de facto standard free web fuzzer.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



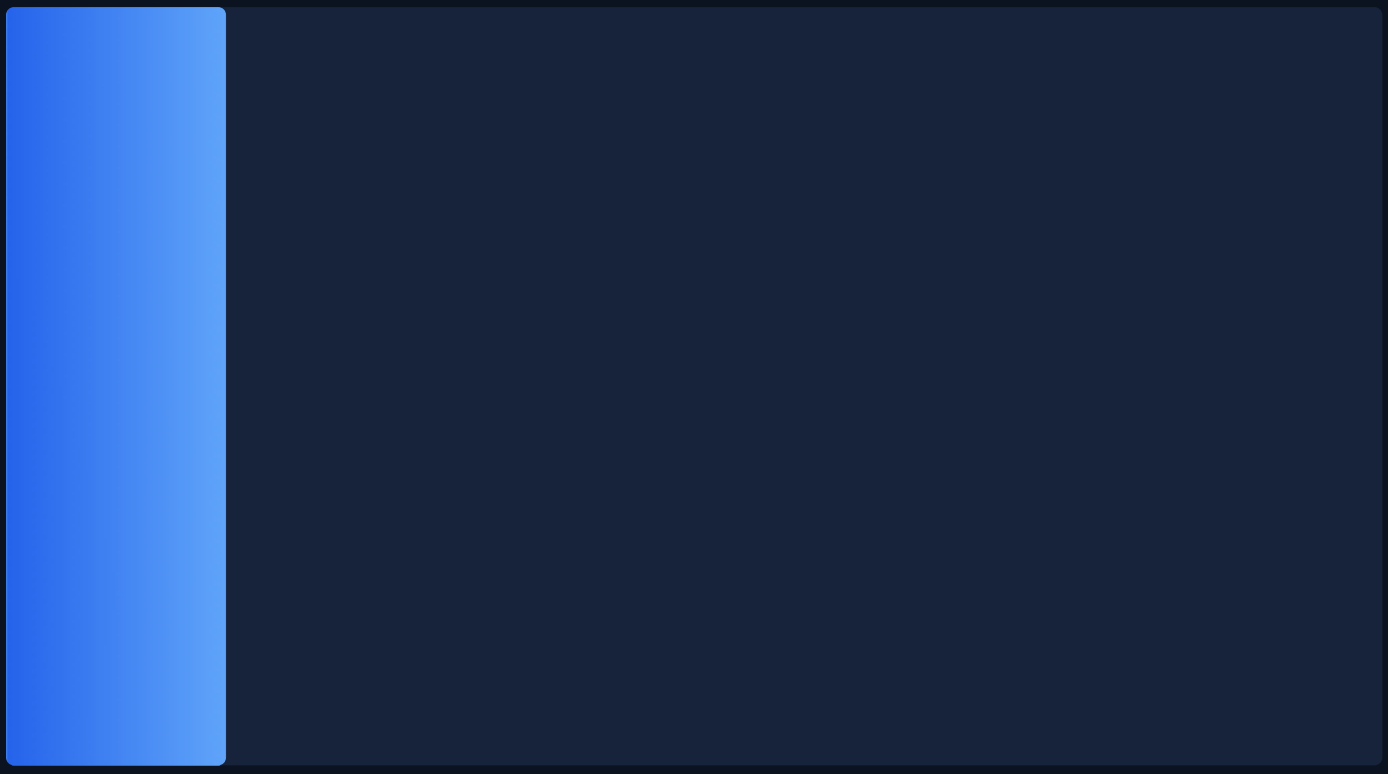
8	1,622	237	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

06 Amass

github.com/owasp-amass/amass

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 15.4k	GITHUB STARS
2,201	FORKS
2026-07	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"In-depth attack surface mapping and asset discovery"

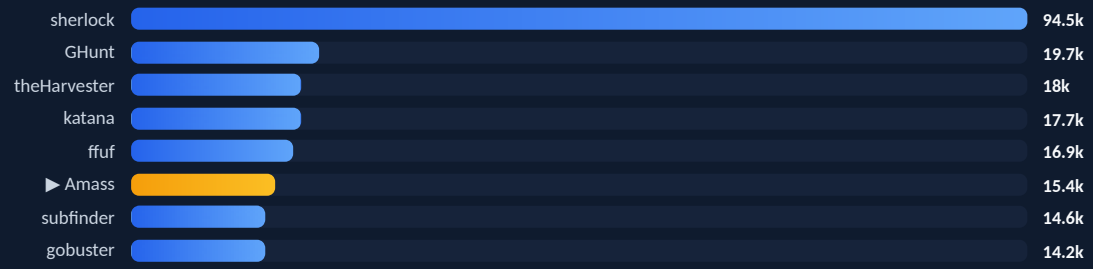
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

deep attack-surface mapping: DNS enumeration, scraping, archives, APIs and permutations in one OWASP project.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by recon teams and bug bounty hunters for deep subdomain enumeration; the OWASP project that anchors most serious attack-surface pipelines.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



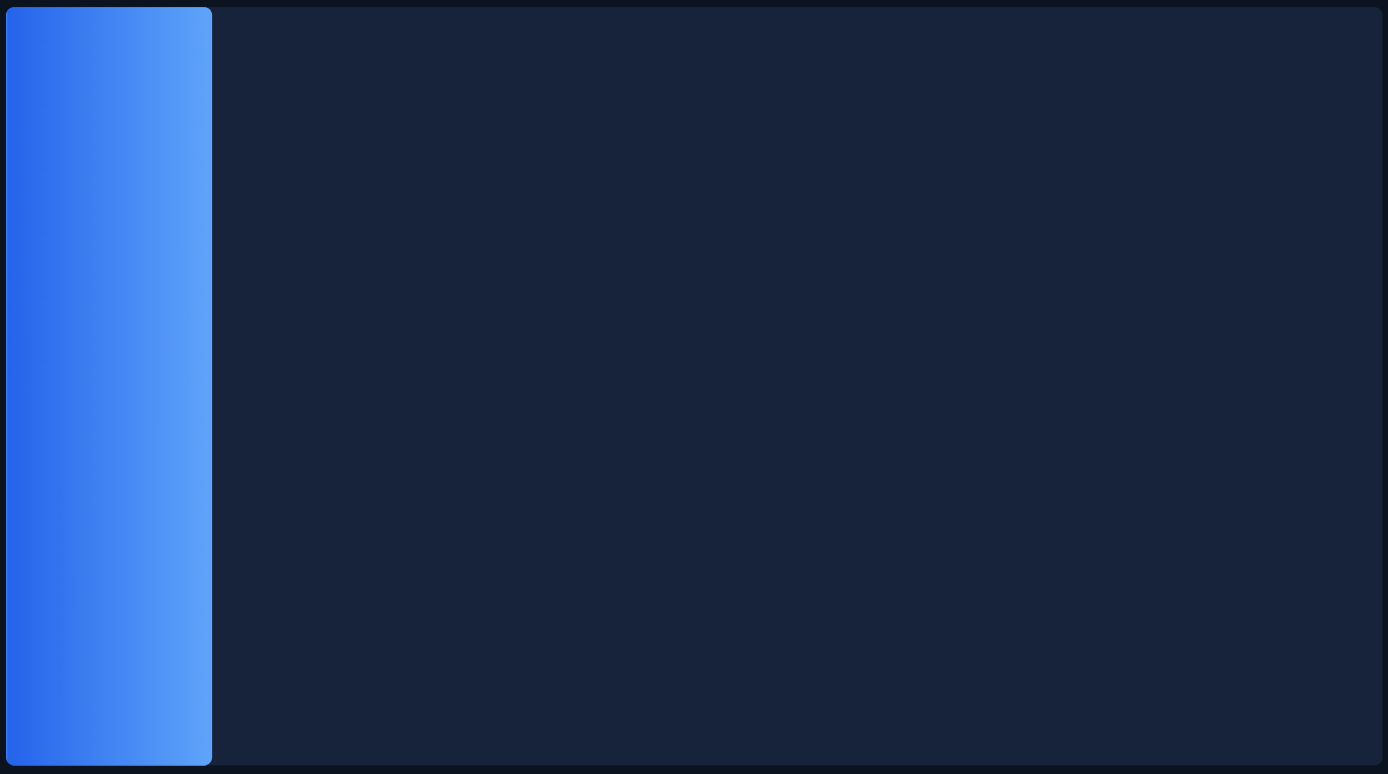
8	2,201	245	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

07 subfinder

github.com/projectdiscovery/subfinder

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 14.6k	GITHUB STARS
1,638	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Fast passive subdomain enumeration tool."

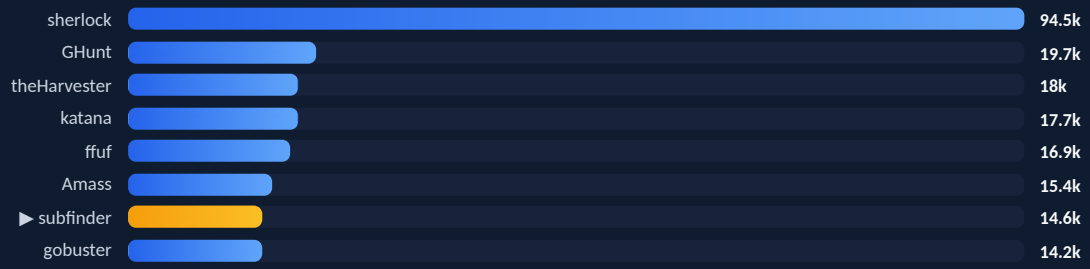
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

fast, passive subdomain discovery from dozens of sources; the standard first command of any engagement.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters for fast passive subdomain discovery; the ProjectDiscovery staple of recon automation.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



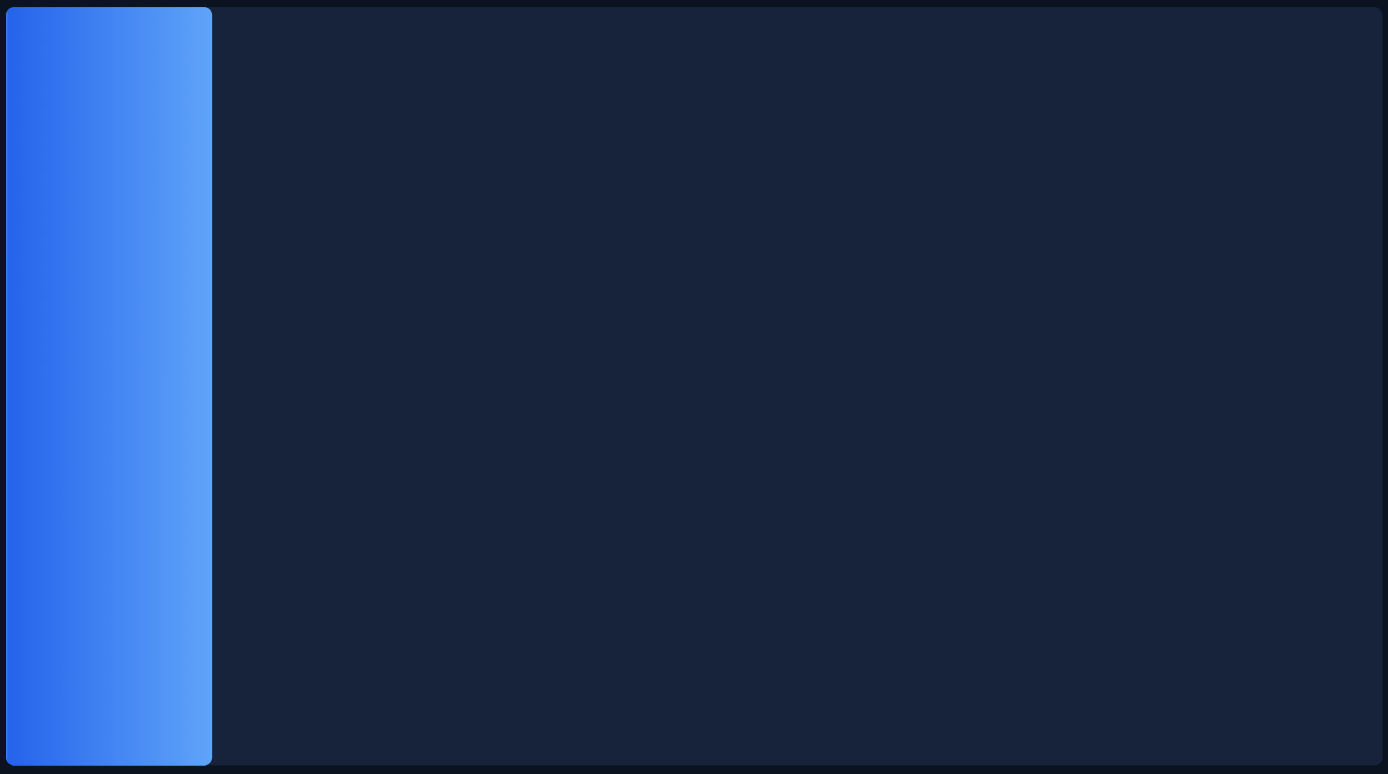
8	1,638	1	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

08 gobuster

github.com/OJ/gobuster

★ FLAGSHIP PICK · ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 14.2k	GITHUB STARS
1,626	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Directory/File, DNS and VHost busting tool written in Go"

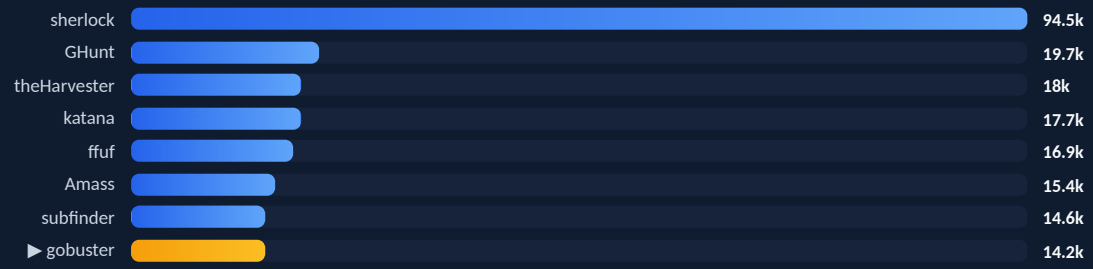
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the classic directory/DNS/vhost buster in Go; the tool feroxbuster and ffuf grew from.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters for directory, DNS and vhost brute-forcing; the veteran free alternative to commercial content scanners.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



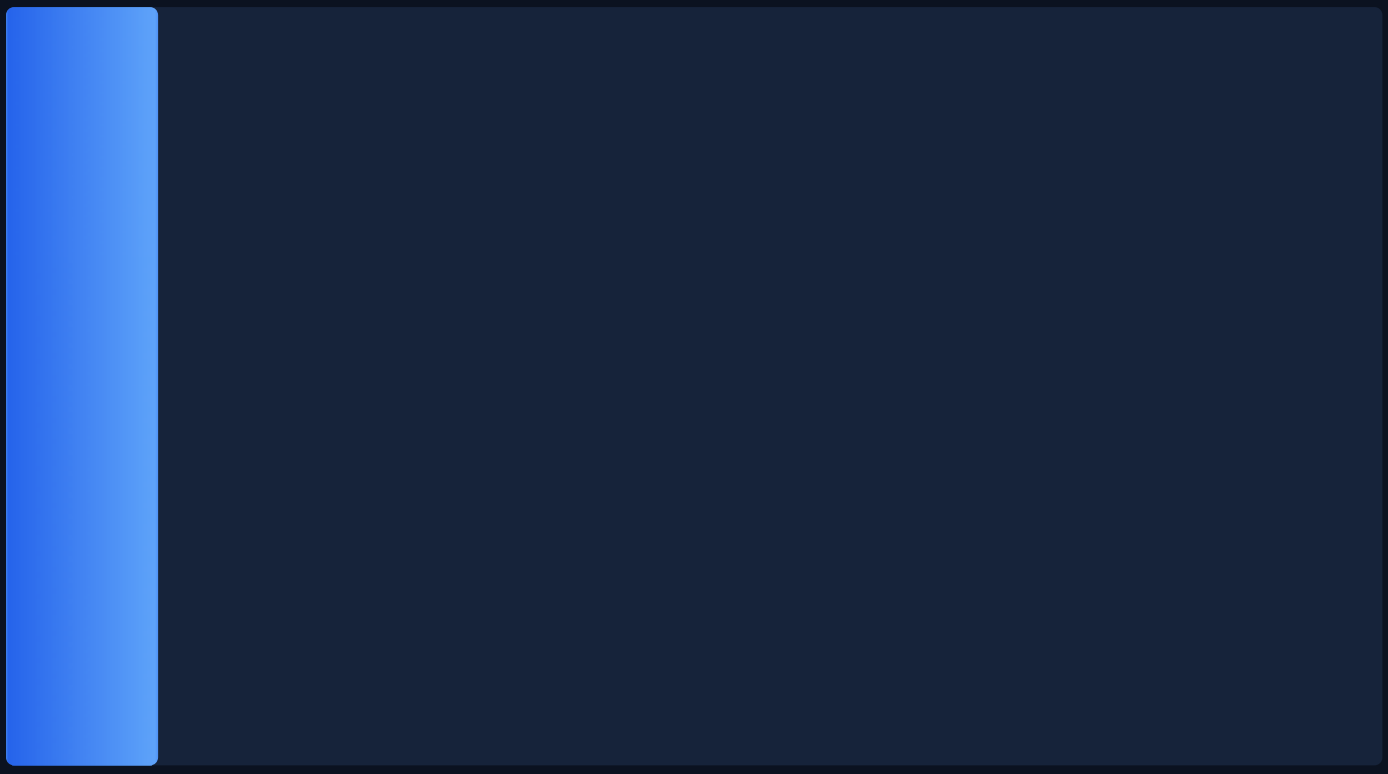
12	1,626	26	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

09 bbot

github.com/blacklanternsecurity/bbot

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 10.7k	GITHUB STARS
936	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2022	FIRST DEVELOPED
AGPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The recursive internet scanner for hackers. 💛"

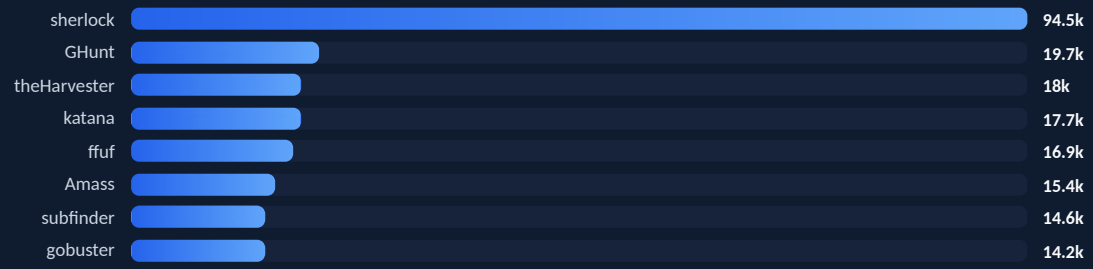
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

recursive, modular OSINT/scanning framework — spider the whole attack surface with one command.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by attack-surface teams running modular, recursive recon; the open-source framework rivaling commercial ASM discovery.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



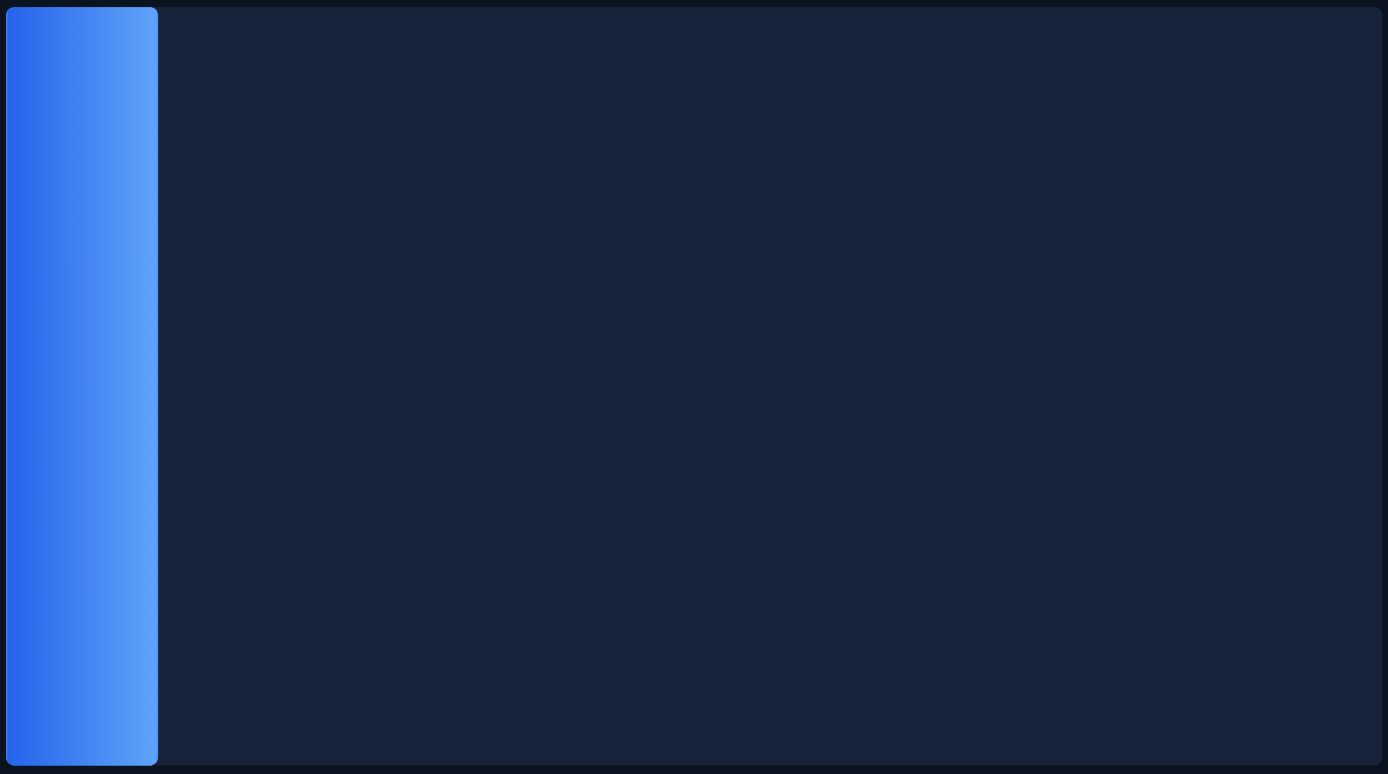
4	936	58	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

10 httpx

github.com/projectdiscovery/httpx

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 10.5k	GITHUB STARS
1,211	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"httpx is a fast and multi-purpose HTTP toolkit that allows running multiple probes using the retryablehttp library."

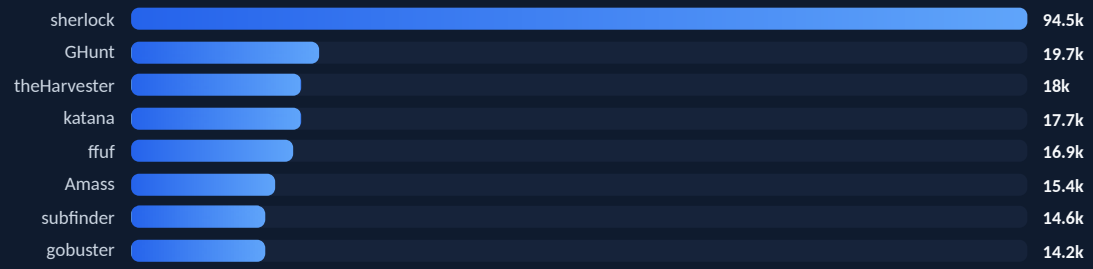
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the HTTP prober: filter thousands of hosts by status, title, tech, CDN and TLS in a single pass.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters triaging alive hosts from mass subdomain lists; the ProjectDiscovery prober in nearly every recon pipeline.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



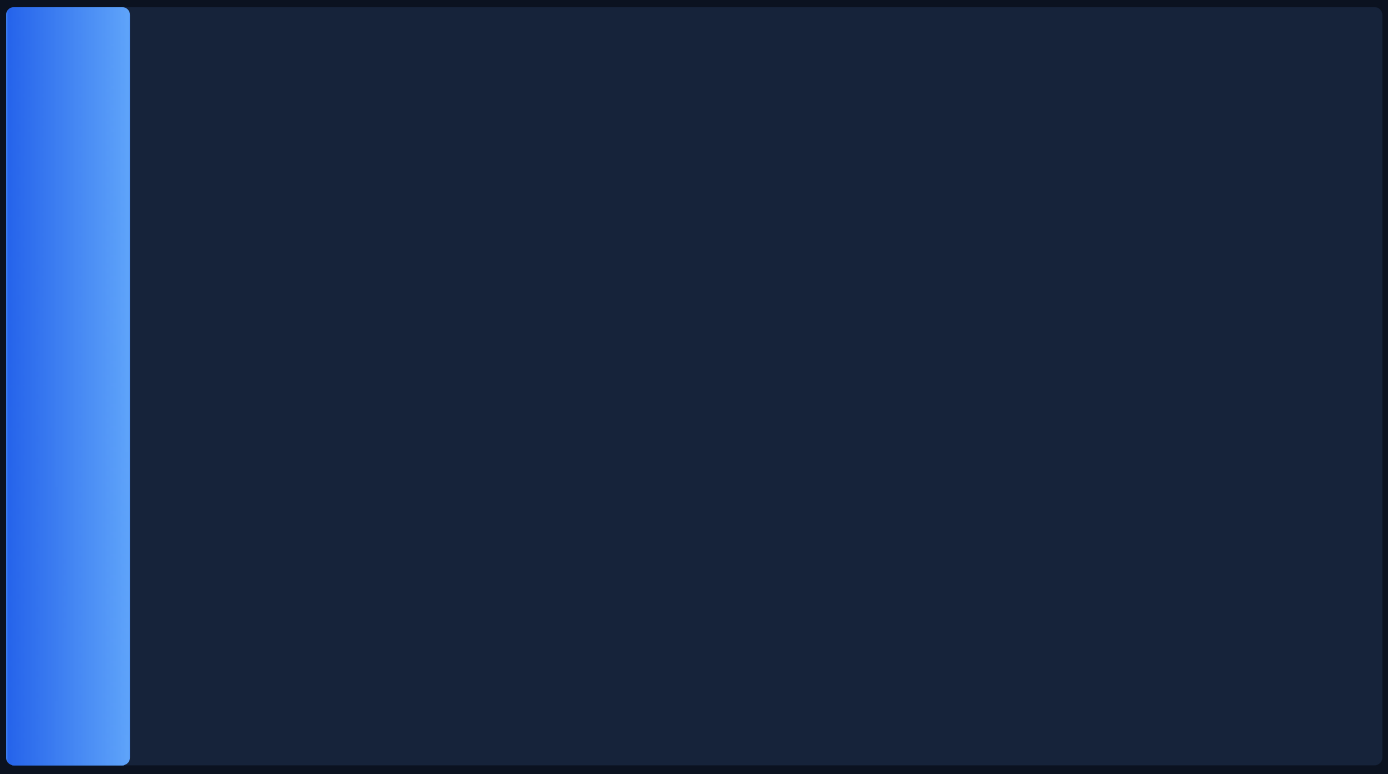
6	1,211	10	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

11 feroxbuster

github.com/epi052/feroxbuster

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 8.1k	GITHUB STARS
636	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Rust	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A fast, simple, recursive content discovery tool written in Rust."

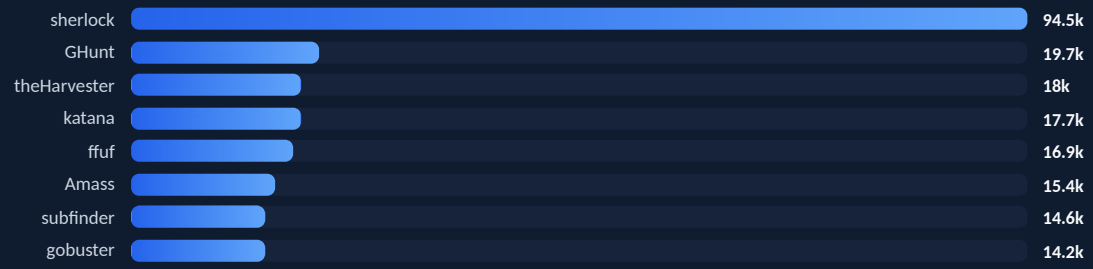
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

fast recursive content discovery in Rust with great heuristics and recursion handling.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by web pentesters for fast recursive content discovery; the Rust-based favorite alongside ffuf and gobuster.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



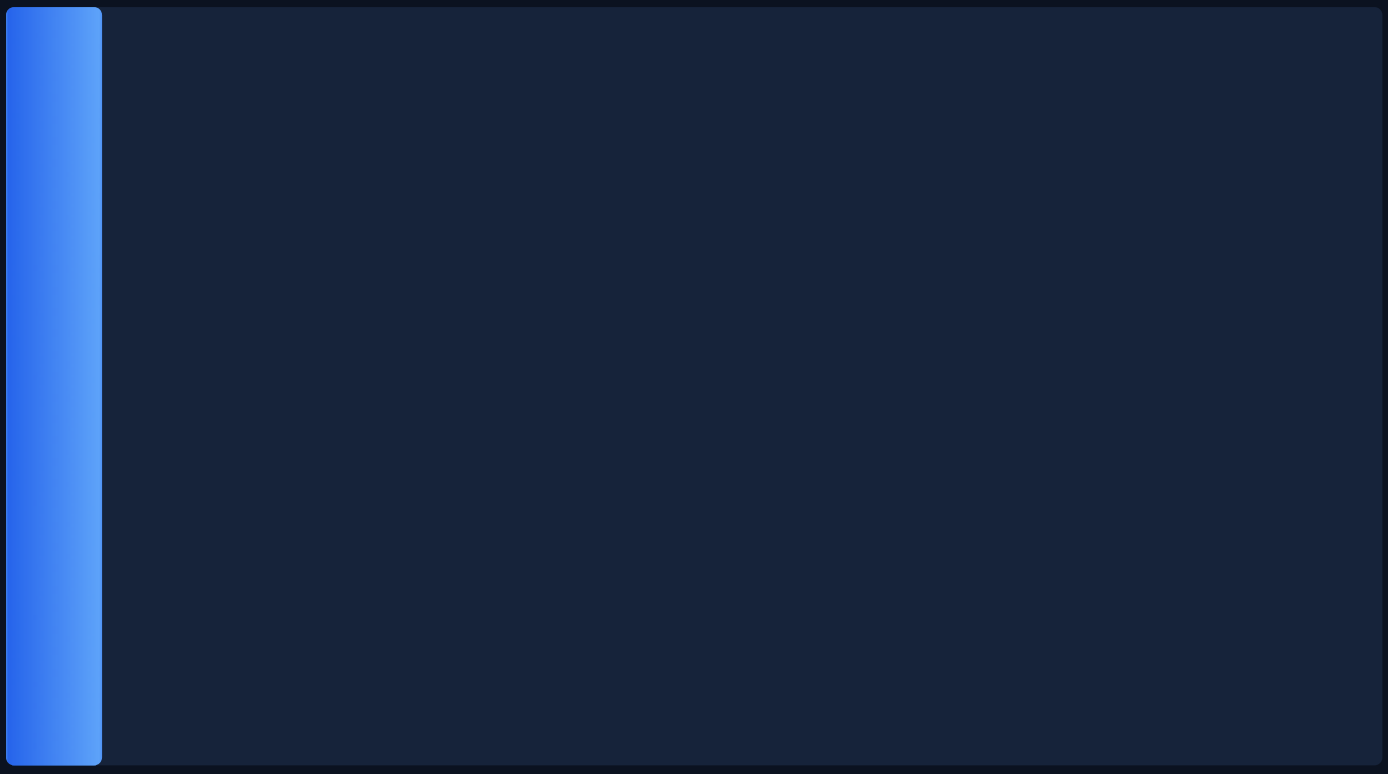
6	636	40	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

12 wfuzz

github.com/xmendez/wfuzz

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.6k	GITHUB STARS
1,398	FORKS
2026-01	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Web application fuzzer"

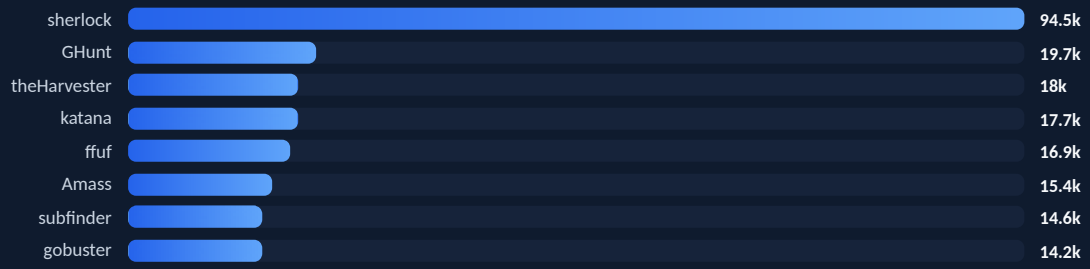
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the web fuzzer that replaces any part of a request with a payload — parameters, headers, paths, verbs.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by web pentesters fuzzing any part of an HTTP request; the classic free fuzzer predating ffuf.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



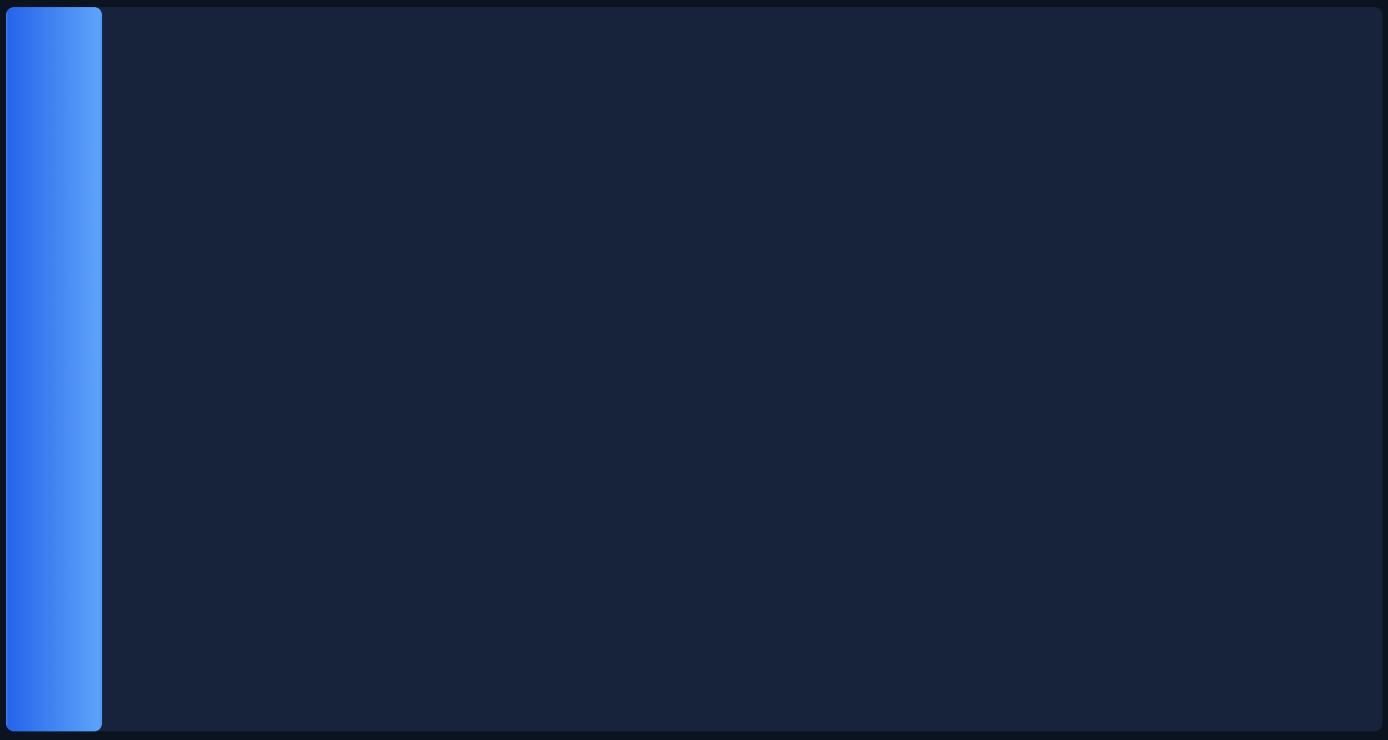
12 YEARS ON GITHUB	1,398 FORKS (REUSE)	116 OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

13 naabu

github.com/projectdiscovery/naabu

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.3k	GITHUB STARS
727	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A fast port scanner written in go with a focus on reliability and simplicity. Designed to be used in combination with other tools for attack surface discovery in bug bounties and pentests"

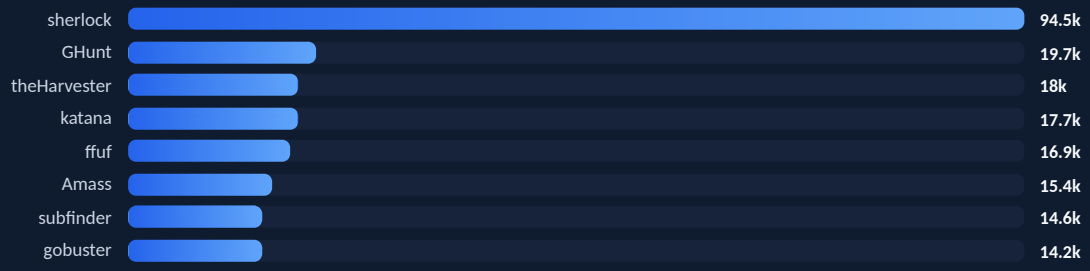
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

fast, SYN-based port scanner built to be pipelined, not watched.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters for SYN port scanning; the ProjectDiscovery port scanner in recon pipelines.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



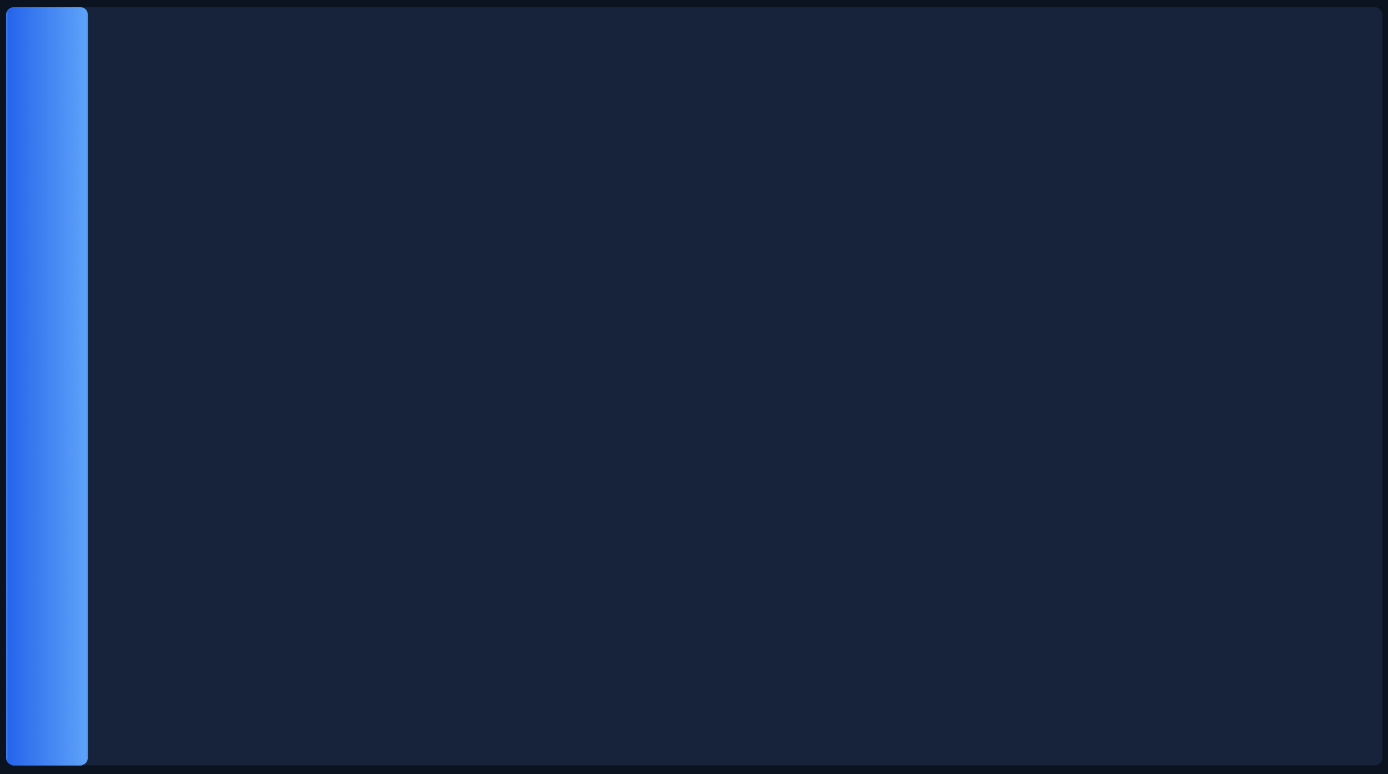
6	727	1	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

14 recon-ng

github.com/lanmaster53/recon-ng

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6k	GITHUB STARS
934	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2019	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Open Source Intelligence gathering tool aimed at reducing the time spent harvesting information from open sources."

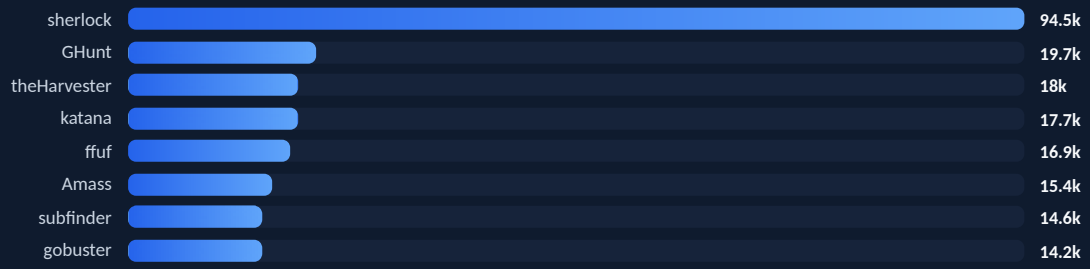
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the other recon framework: fully modular, database-backed web recon with a Metasploit-style console.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters running structured recon workflows; the Metasploit-style framework for the recon phase.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



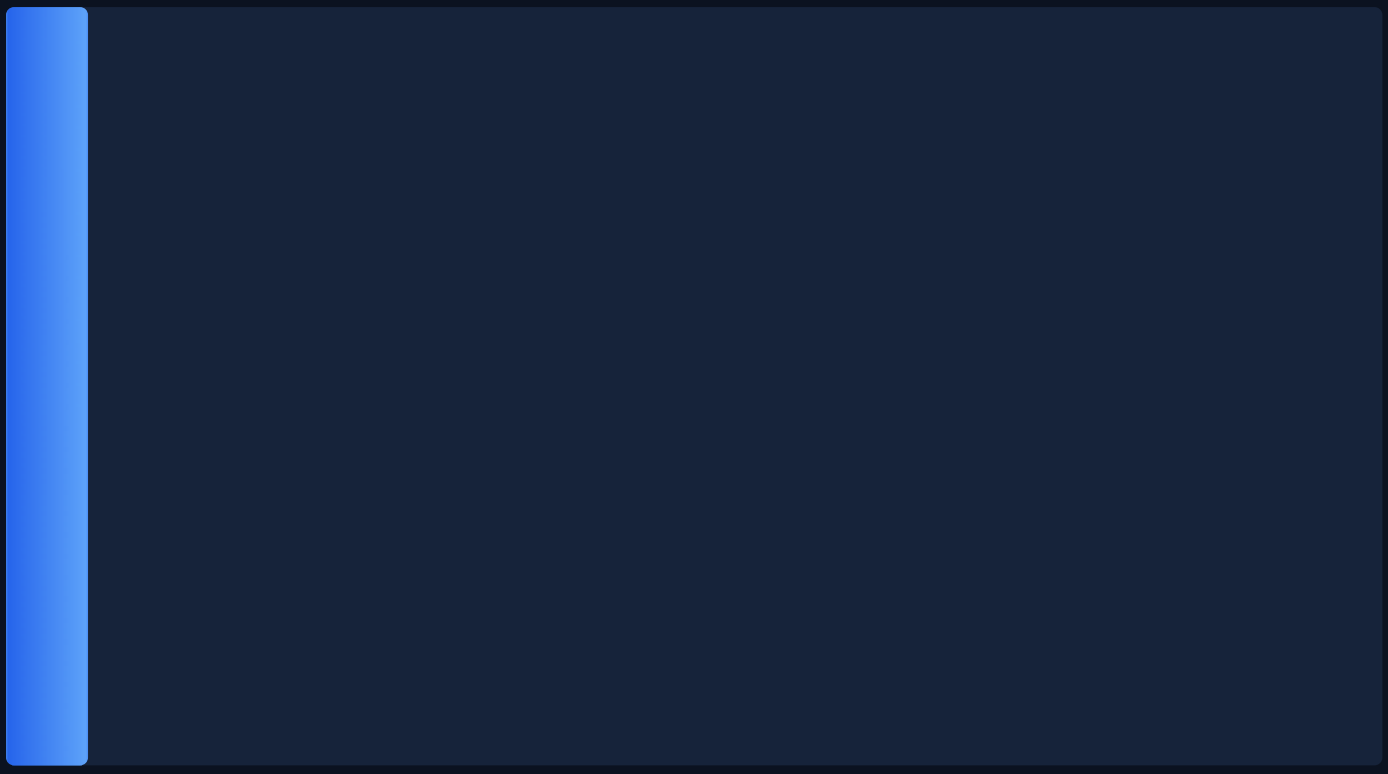
7	934	39	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

15 EyeWitness

github.com/RedSiege/EyeWitness

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.9k	GITHUB STARS
905	FORKS
2026-01	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"EyeWitness is designed to take screenshots of websites, provide some server header info, and identify default credentials if possible."

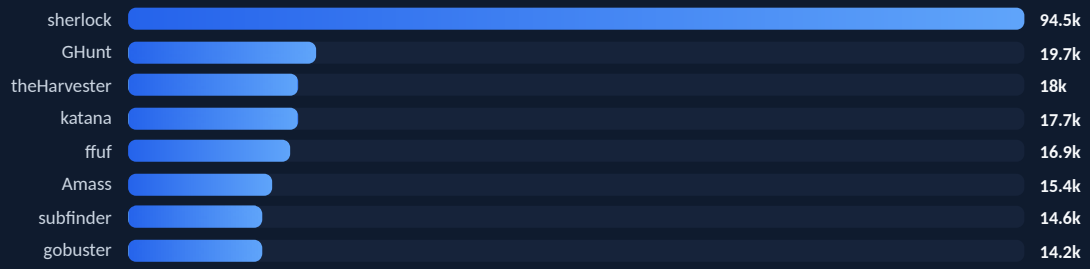
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

screenshots, headers and key info from web servers during authorized recon passes.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters screenshotting and triaging web servers in bulk; the standard free recon triage tool.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

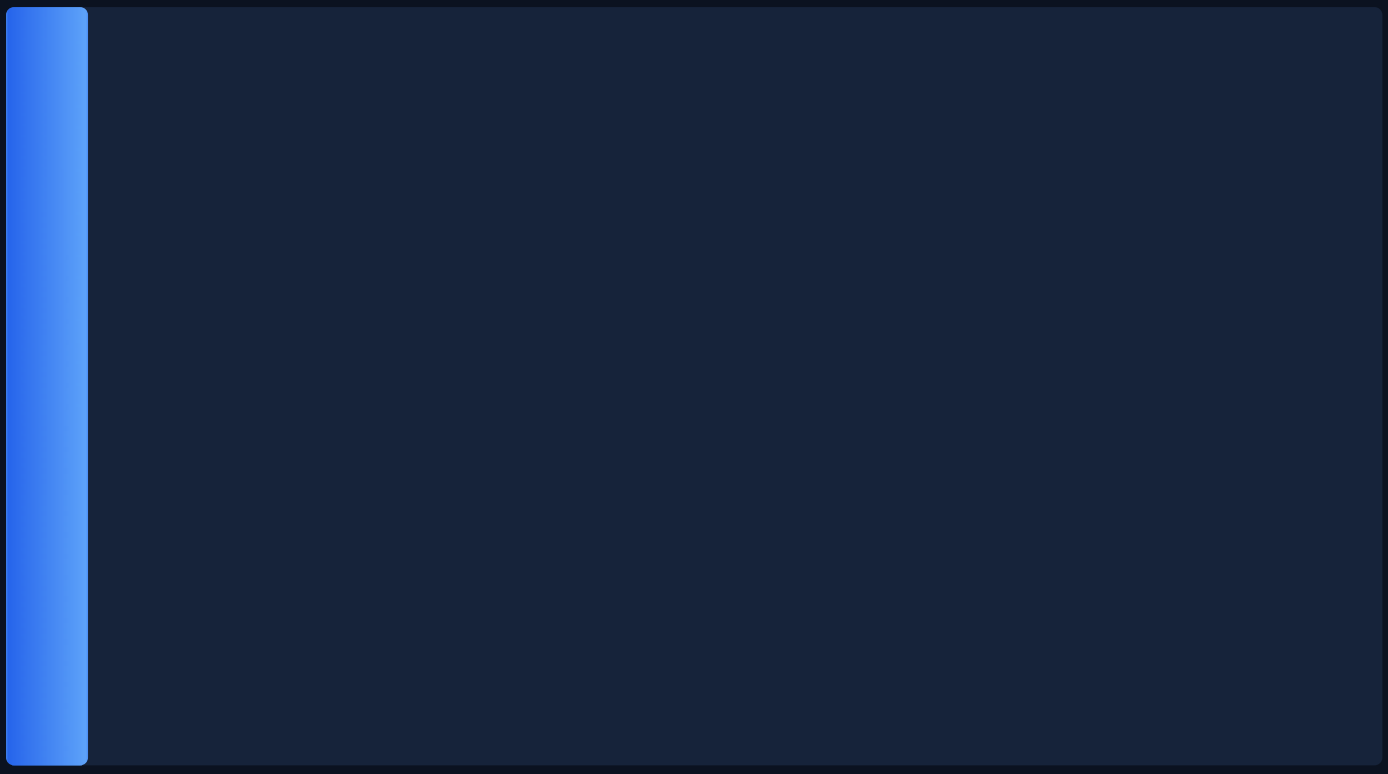


12	905	30	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

16 dnstwist

github.com/elceef/dnstwist

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.8k	GITHUB STARS
856	FORKS
2025-04	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Domain name permutation engine for detecting homograph phishing attacks, typo squatting, and brand impersonation"

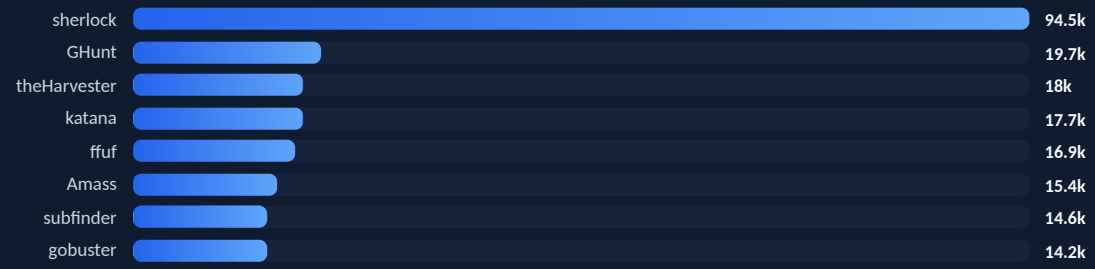
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

detect typosquat, homograph and permutation lookalikes of your domain — a must for phishing defense and brand monitoring.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by brand-protection and anti-phishing teams hunting lookalike domains; the open-source alternative to commercial domain-monitoring services.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



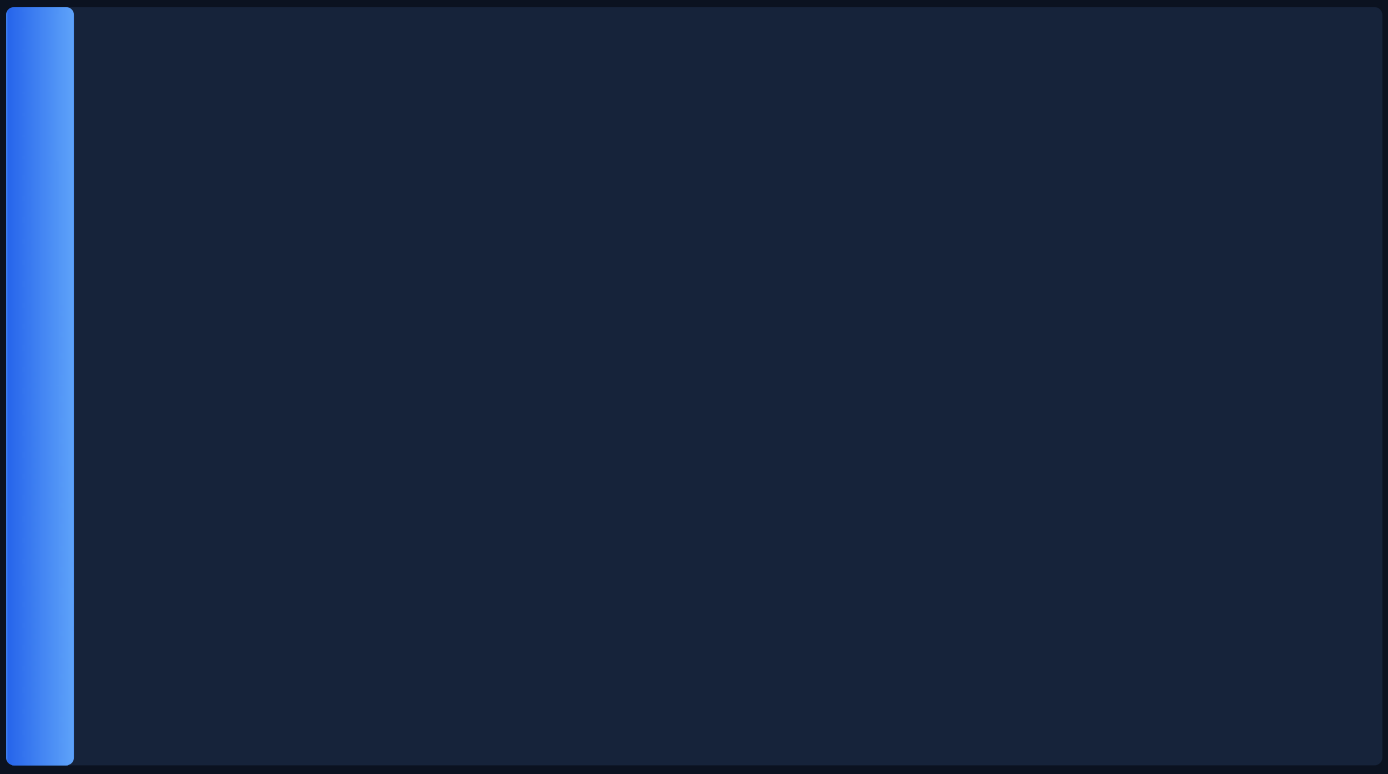
11	856	20	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

17 gau

github.com/lc/gau

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.1k	GITHUB STARS
525	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Fetch known URLs from AlienVault's Open Threat Exchange, the Wayback Machine, and Common Crawl."

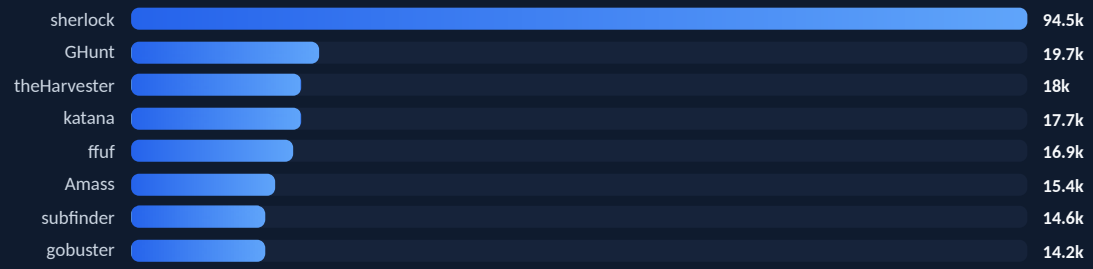
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

fetch URLs indexed by AlienVault OTX, the Wayback Machine and Common Crawl.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters pulling all known URLs from public archives; the free fetcher that seeds most recon pipelines.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

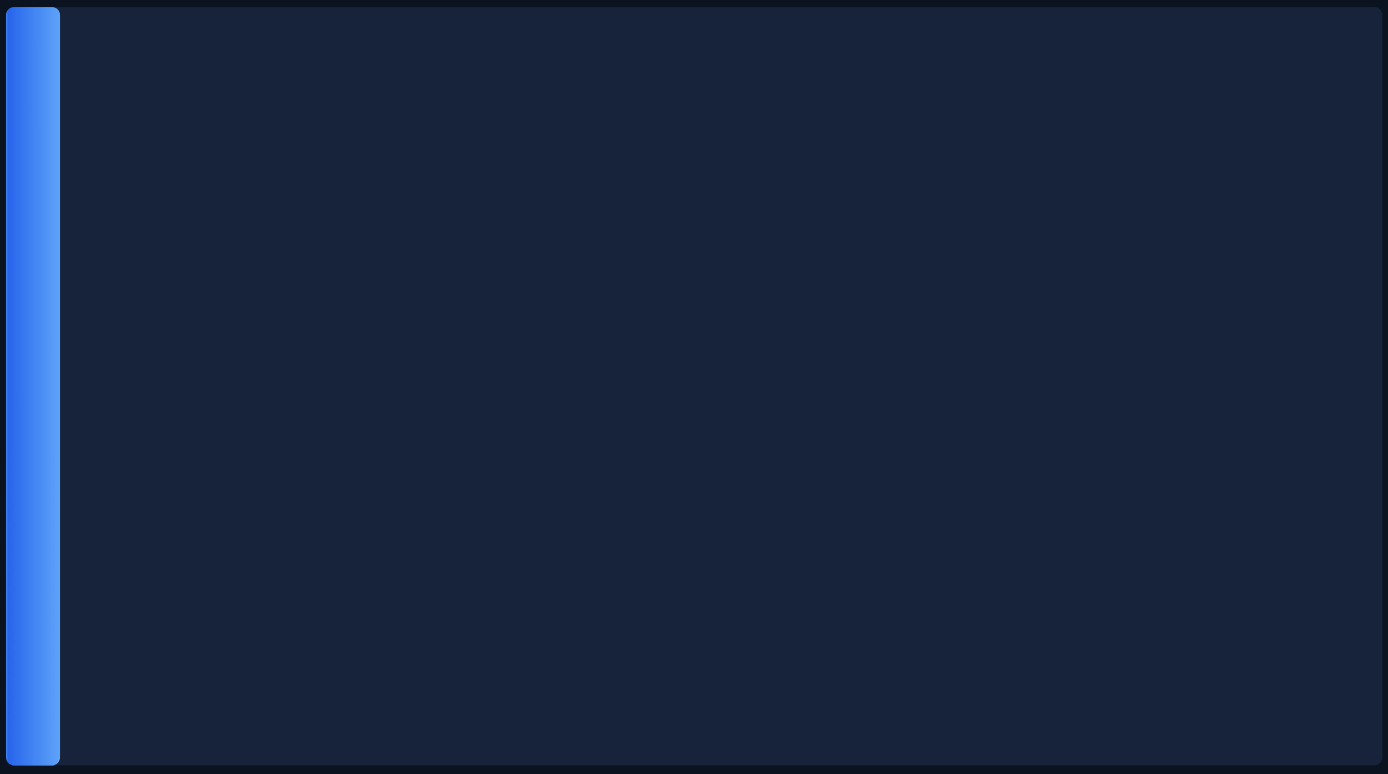


6	525	29	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

18 assetfinder

github.com/tomnomnom/assetfinder

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.7k	GITHUB STARS
548	FORKS
2024-06	LAST PUSH
2019	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Find domains and subdomains related to a given domain"

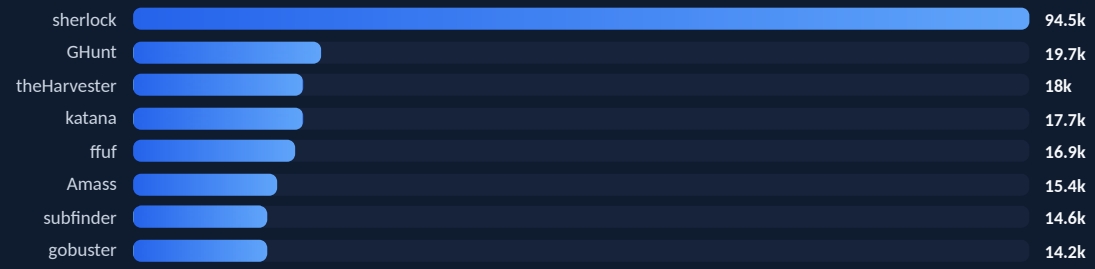
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

passive subdomain discovery that polls a dozen public sources and prints a clean list — no keys needed; quiet upstream, still the classic.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters for quick passive subdomain finds; the lightweight staple of recon one-liners.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



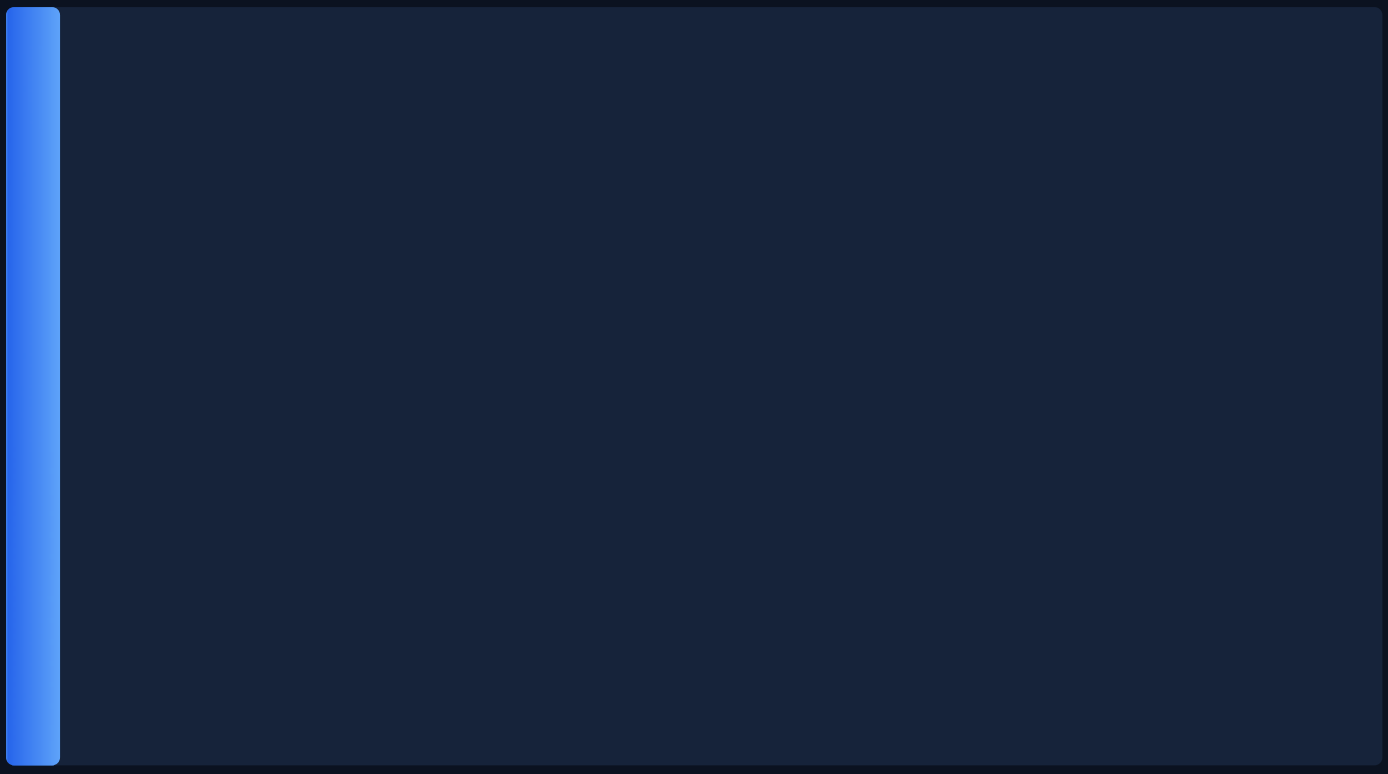
7	548	43	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

19 massdns

github.com/blechschmidt/massdns

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.7k	GITHUB STARS
506	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A high-performance DNS stub resolver for bulk lookups and reconnaissance (subdomain enumeration)"

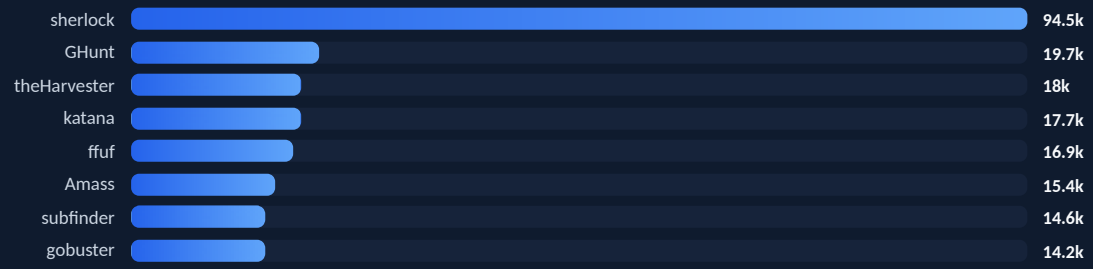
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

high-performance DNS stub resolver for bulk subdomain brute-forcing at scale.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by recon pipelines resolving millions of subdomains; the free high-performance resolver no commercial tool beats on price.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



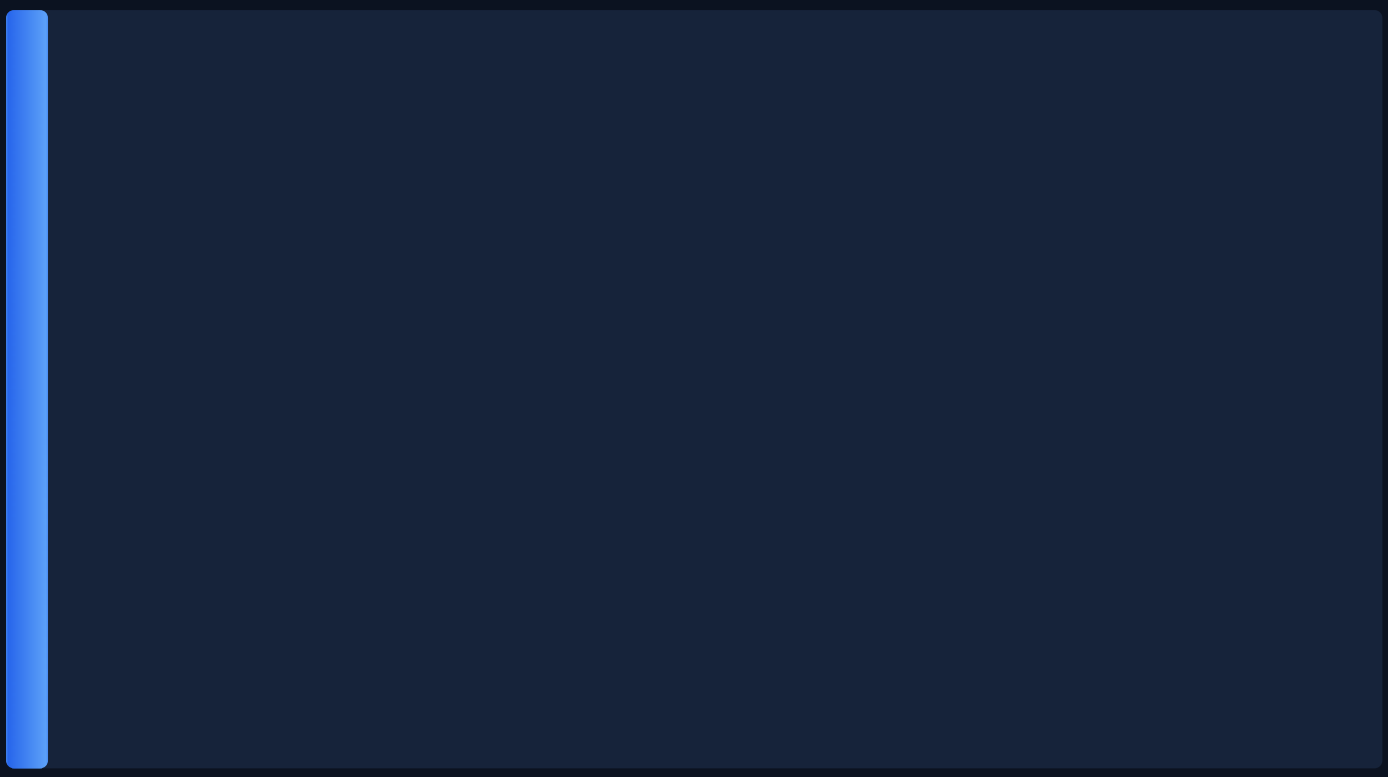
10	506	14	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

20 ParamSpider

github.com/devanshbatham/ParamSpider

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.2k	GITHUB STARS
480	FORKS
2026-03	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“ Mining URLs from dark corners of Web Archives for bug hunting/fuzzing/further probing ”

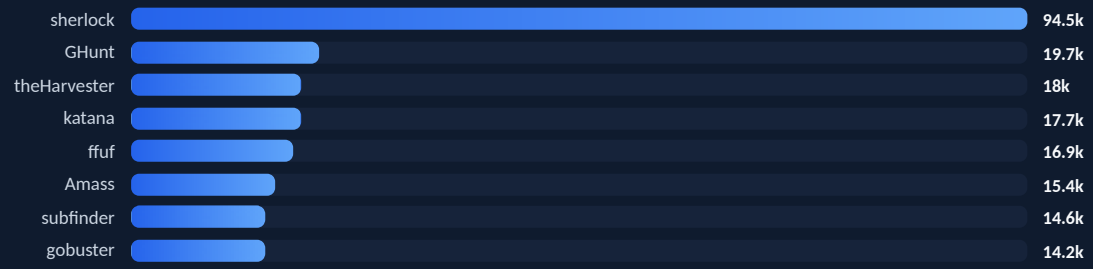
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

mines archived URLs and parameters from the Wayback Machine to seed injection testing.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug hunters mining hidden parameters from archives; the free parameter-mining step before injection testing.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

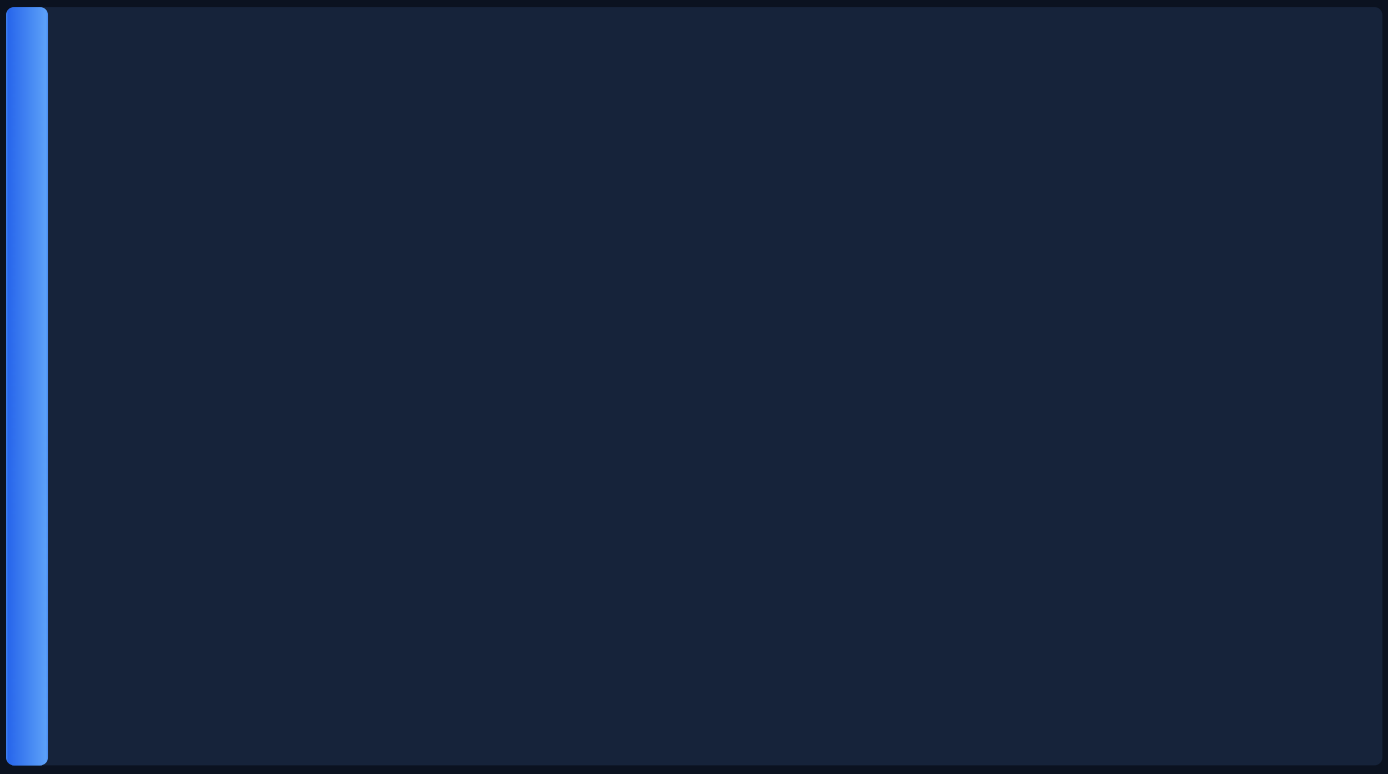


6	480	40	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

21 JA3

github.com/salesforce/ja3

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.1k	GITHUB STARS
313	FORKS
2025-05	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
BSD-3-Clause	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"JA3 is a standard for creating SSL client fingerprints in an easy to produce and shareable way."

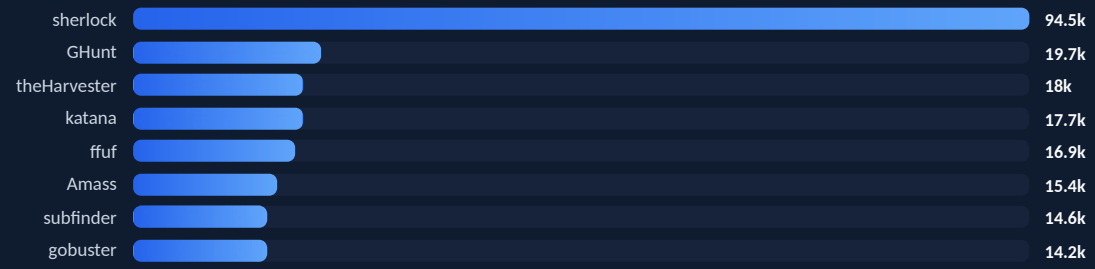
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the TLS client fingerprint standard: a 12-byte hash that identifies client software across the wire.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by defenders detecting C2 and by researchers fingerprinting TLS clients; the free hashing standard adopted by commercial sensors too.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



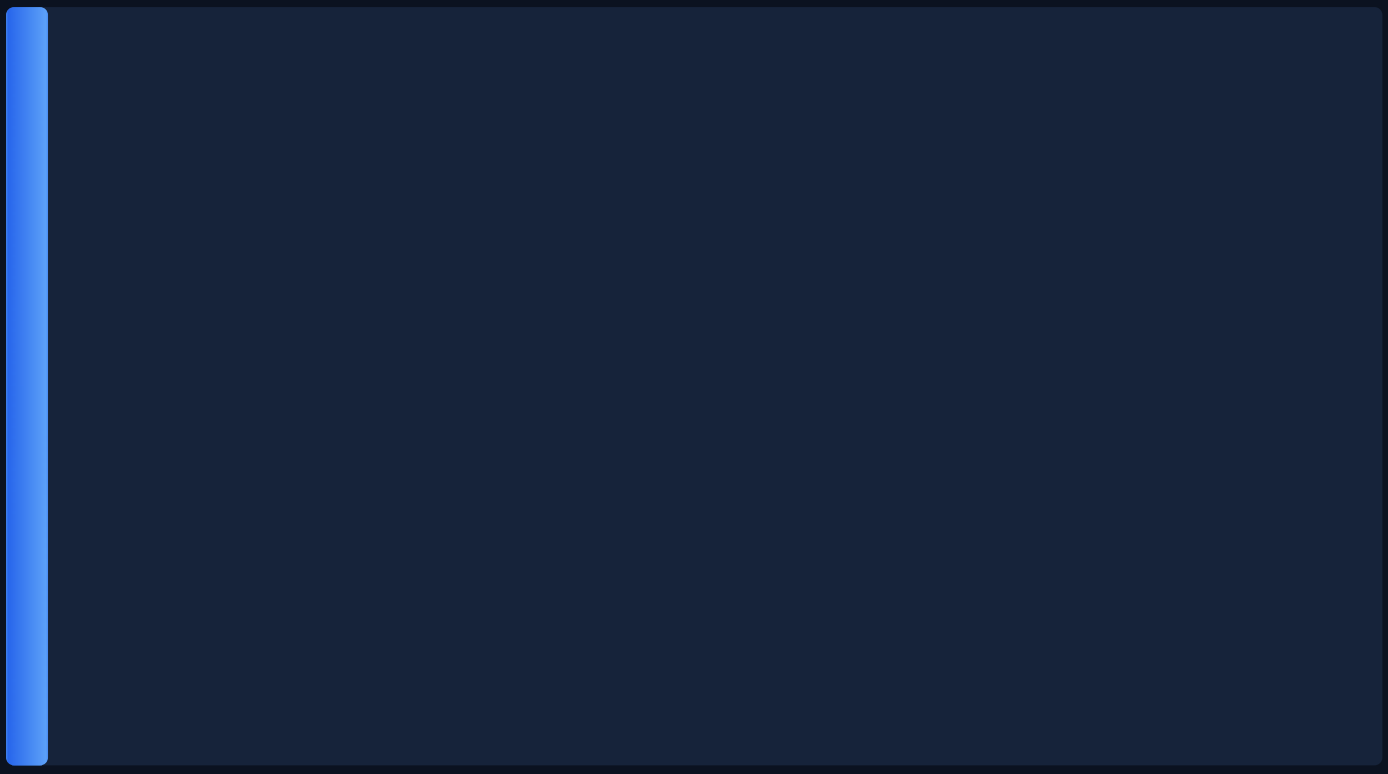
9	313	34	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

22 dnsrecon

github.com/darkoperator/dnsrecon

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.1k	GITHUB STARS
576	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2010	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"DNS Enumeration Script"

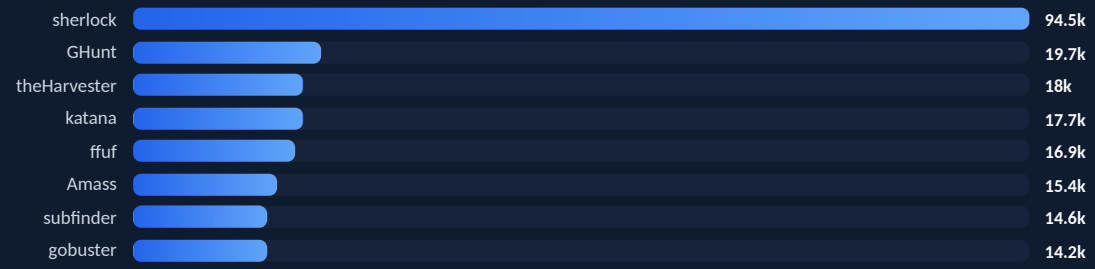
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

DNS enumeration workhorse: records, zone transfers, reverse lookups and subdomain brute-forcing.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters enumerating DNS records and zone transfers; the veteran free DNS enumeration tool.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



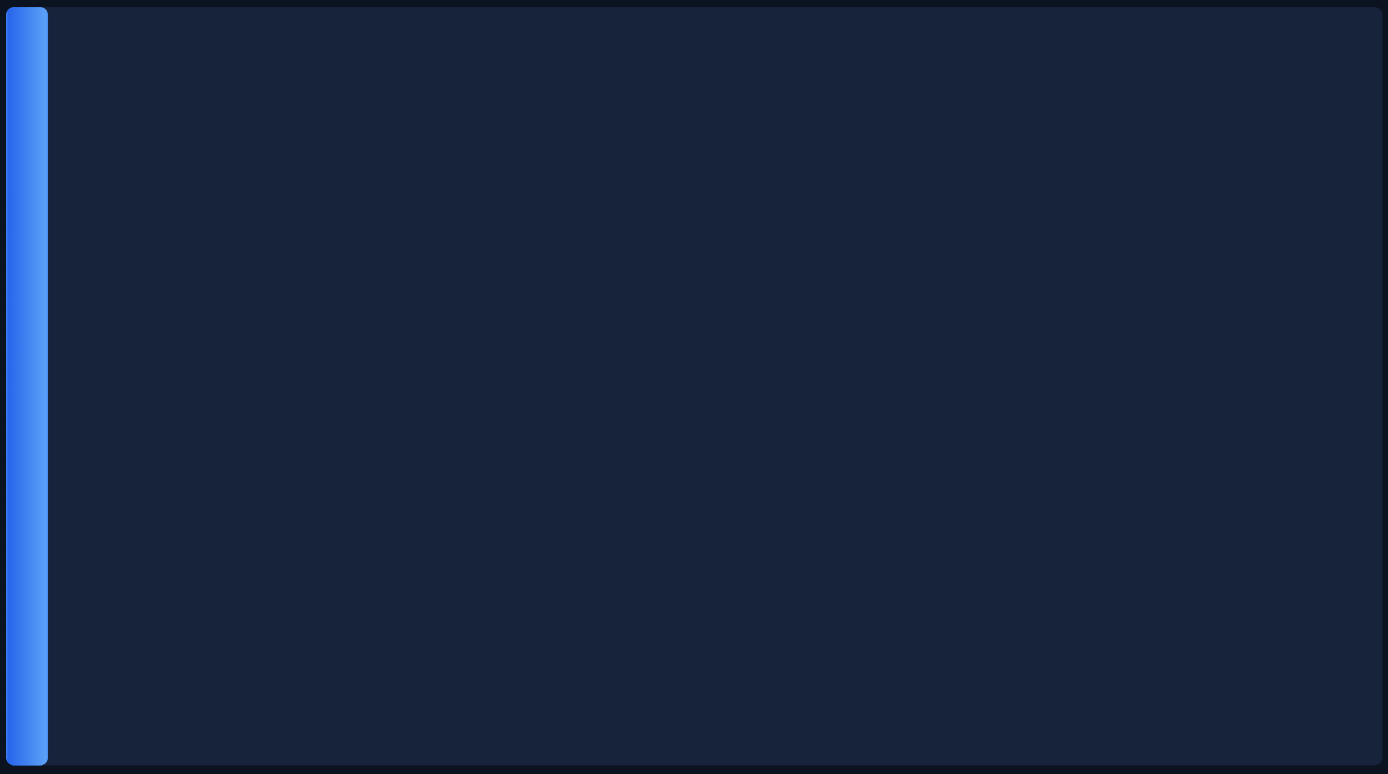
16	576	2	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

23 FinalRecon

github.com/thewhiteh4t/FinalRecon

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3k	GITHUB STARS
521	FORKS
2026-06	LAST PUSH
2019	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"All In One Web Recon"

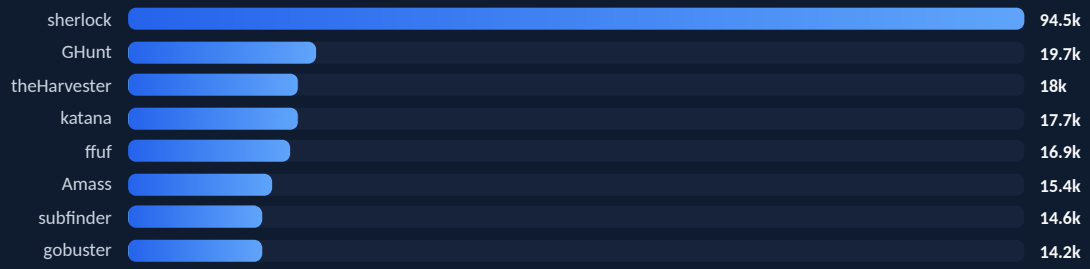
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

all-in-one web recon: headers, whois, SSL, DNS, subdomains, ports, directories and traceroute in a single modular run.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters running a fast first-pass recon sweep before deep-dive tooling; the modular Python alternative to juggling ten single-purpose scripts.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



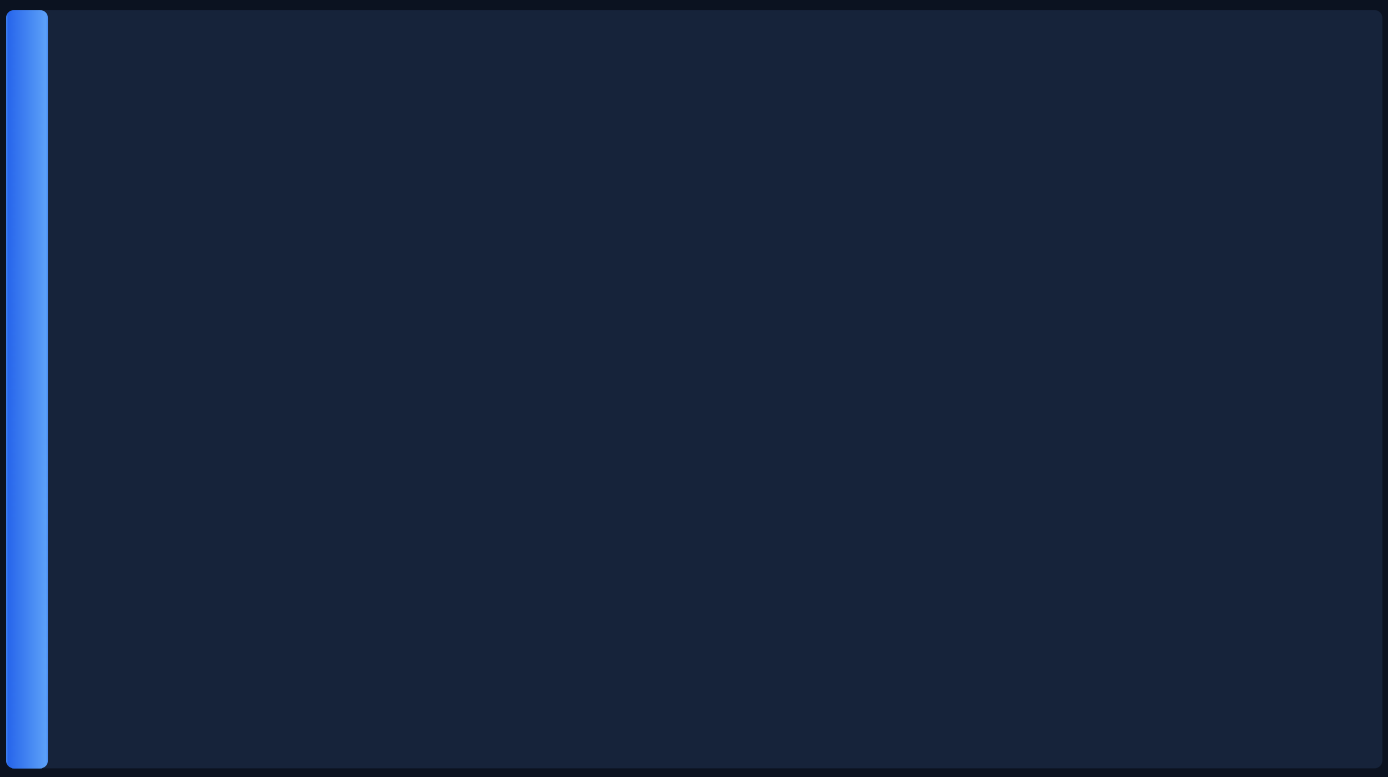
7	521	12	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

24 dnsx

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/projectdiscovery/dnsx

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.9k	GITHUB STARS
337	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"dnsx is a fast and multi-purpose DNS toolkit allow to run multiple DNS queries of your choice with a list of user-supplied resolvers."

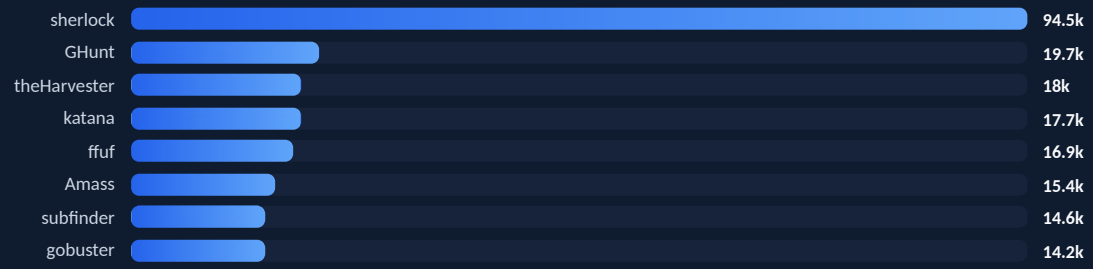
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

multi-purpose DNS toolkit: reverse lookups, wildcard detection, response filtering.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by recon teams for DNS querying and reverse lookups at scale; the ProjectDiscovery DNS multitool.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



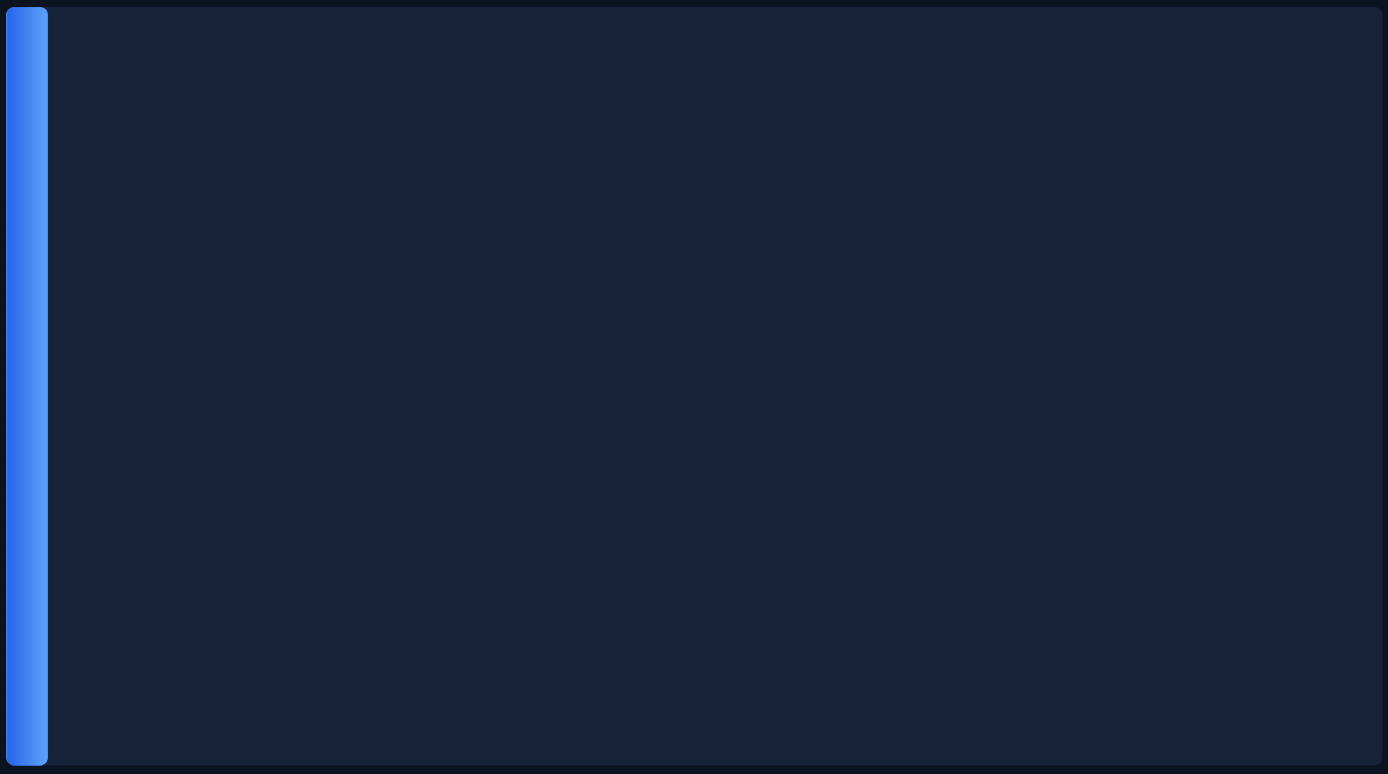
6	337	3	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

25 waymore

github.com/xnl-h4ck3r/waymore

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.8k	GITHUB STARS
298	FORKS
2026-06	LAST PUSH
2022	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Find way more from the Wayback Machine, Common Crawl, Alien Vault OTX, URLScan, VirusTotal, GhostArchive & Intelligence X!"

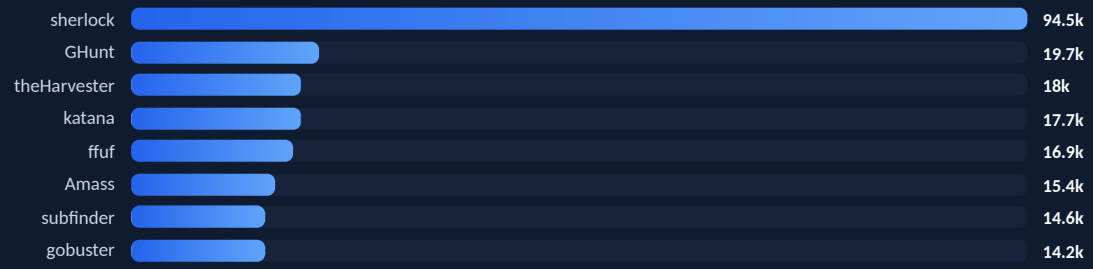
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

pull way more from the Wayback Machine: full responses, not just URLs.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug hunters mining the Wayback Machine deeply for hidden endpoints and parameters; the successor to gau for archive URL intel.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



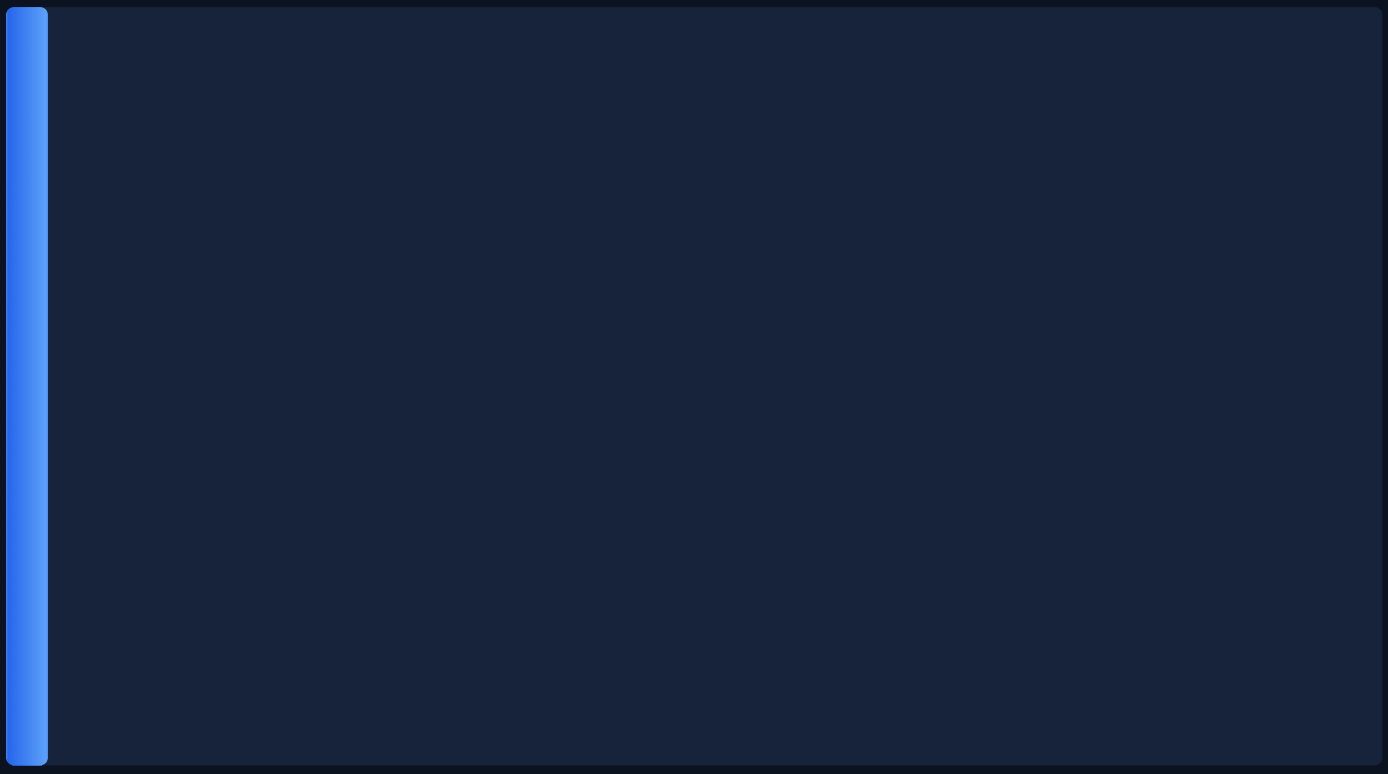
4	298	4	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

26 CloakQuest3r

github.com/spyboy-productions/CloakQuest3r

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.3k	GITHUB STARS
303	FORKS
2026-01	LAST PUSH
2023	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Open-source security research tool for identifying origin IP exposure of websites protected by Cloudflare and similar reverse proxy services."

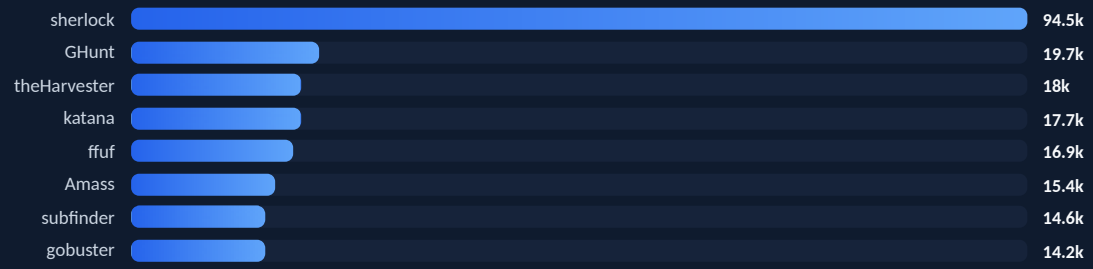
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

unmask the real origin IP behind Cloudflare and similar CDNs using historical DNS, SSL certificates and subdomain correlation.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by security teams verifying true origin exposure before hardening allowlists; the open-source alternative to commercial CDN-unmasking services.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



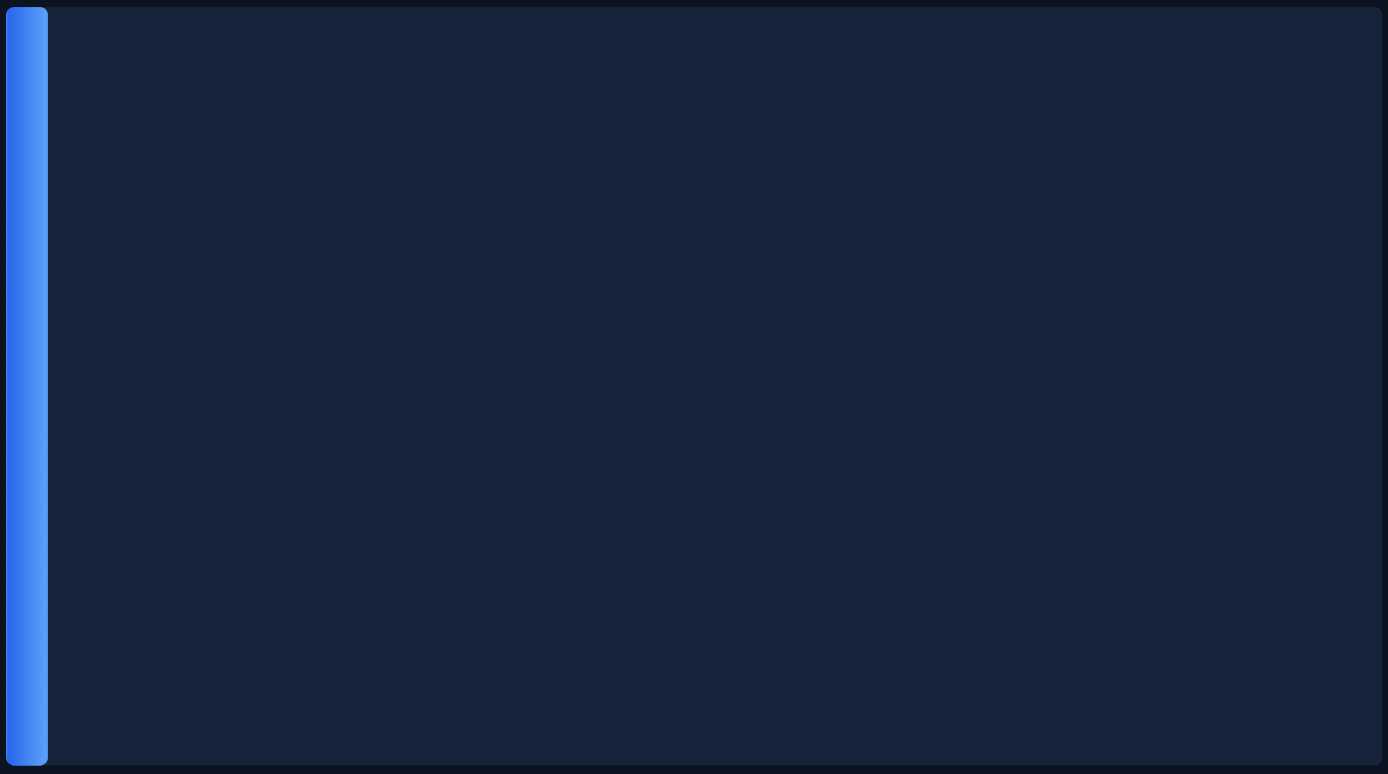
3	303	0	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

27 JARM

github.com/salesforce/jarm

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.3k	GITHUB STARS
156	FORKS
2026-08	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
BSD-3-Clause	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"JARM"

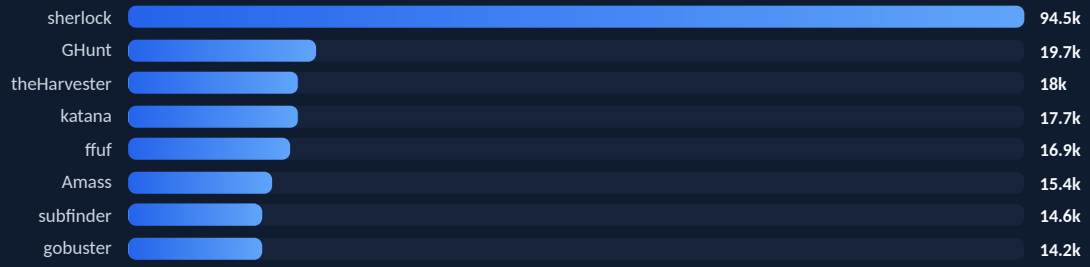
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

active TLS server fingerprint: identifies servers behind CDNs from their handshake behavior.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTI analysts identifying TLS server infrastructure; the free passive fingerprint actively used in threat research.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

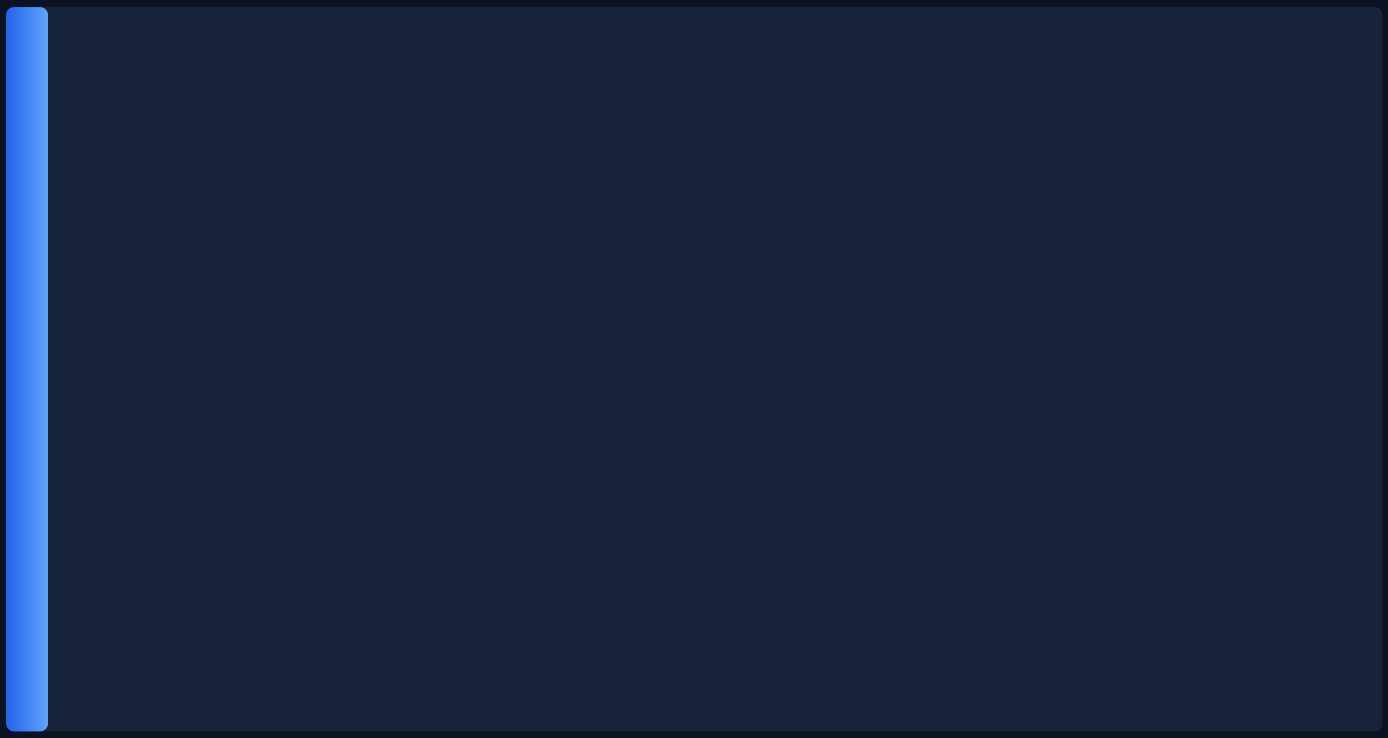


6	156	16	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

28 VHostScan

github.com/codingo/VHostScan

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.3k	GITHUB STARS
237	FORKS
2025-08	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A virtual host scanner that performs reverse lookups, can be used with pivot tools, detect catch-all scenarios, work around wildcards, aliases and dynamic default pages."

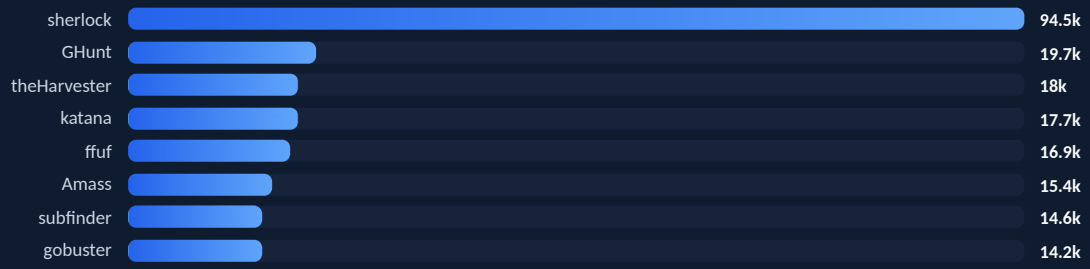
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

enumerates virtual hosts on a shared IP — discover the neighbors your target lives with.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters discovering virtual hosts on shared infrastructure; a focused free tool for shared-hosting engagements.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



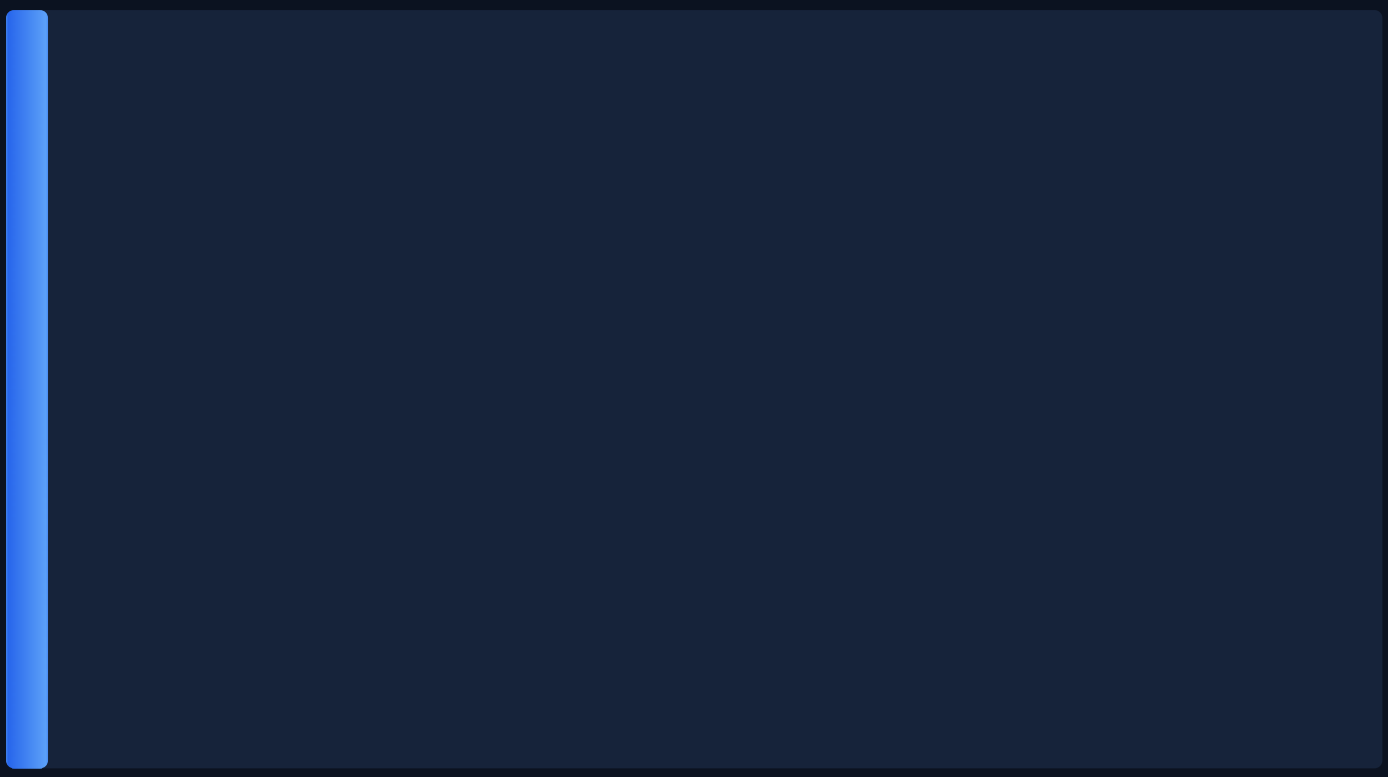
9	237	1	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

29 Awesome Censys Queries

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/thehappydinoa/awesome-censys-queries

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.2k	GITHUB STARS
135	FORKS
2026-07	LAST PUSH
2022	FIRST DEVELOPED
CC0-1.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A collection of fascinating and bizarre Censys Search Queries"

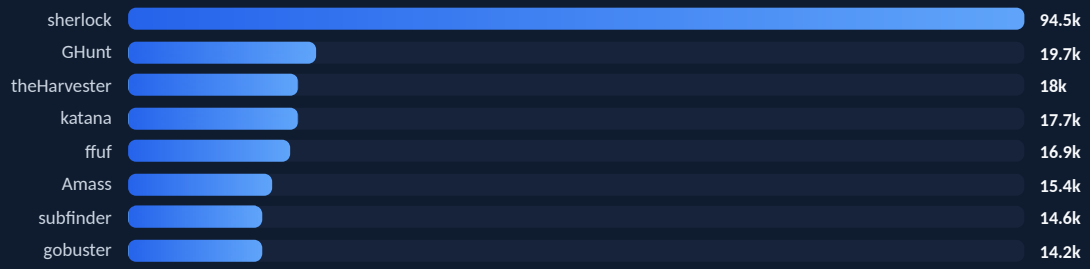
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

a curated corpus of Censys search queries for internet-wide recon.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTI analysts running certified Censys hunting; the community cookbook for asset-search queries.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



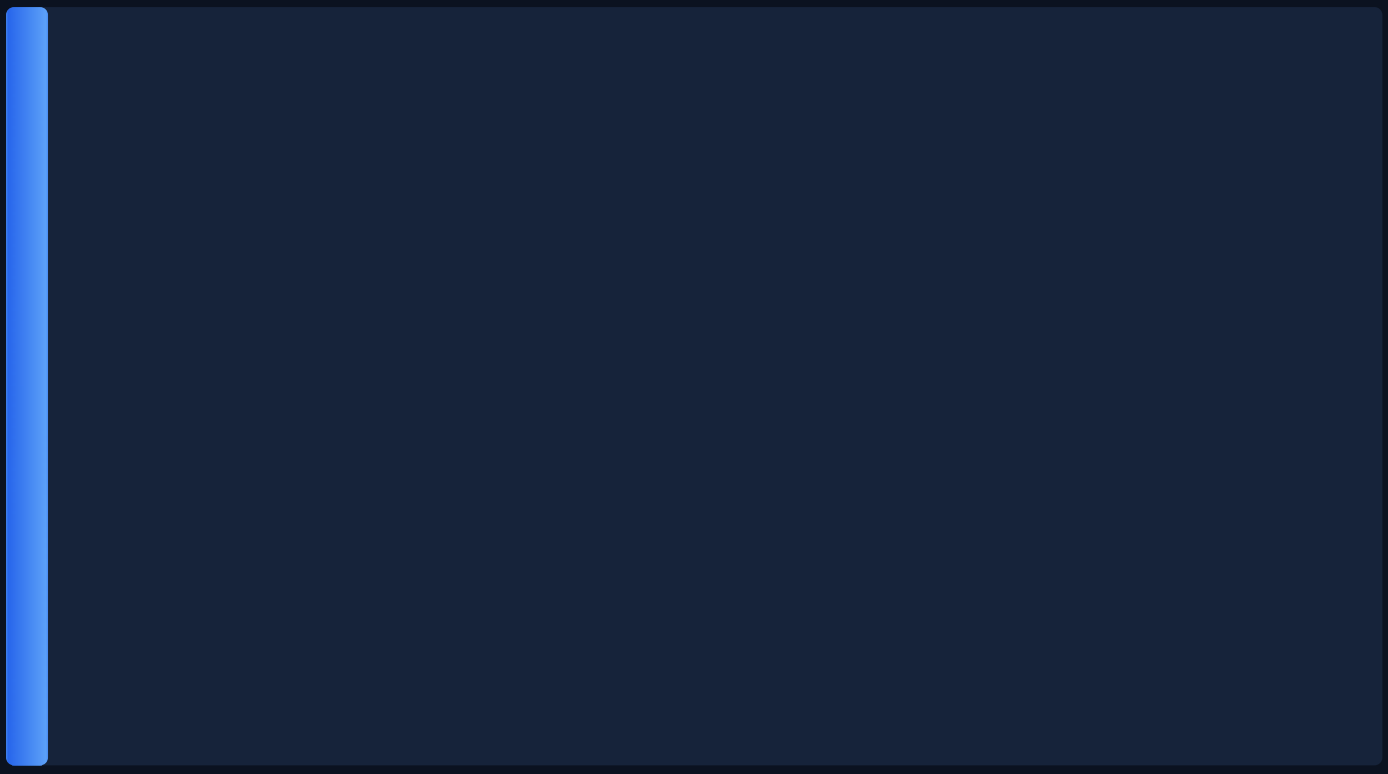
4	135	2	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

30 Recog

github.com/rapid7/recog

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 795	GITHUB STARS
215	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Ruby	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Pattern recognition for hosts, services, and content"

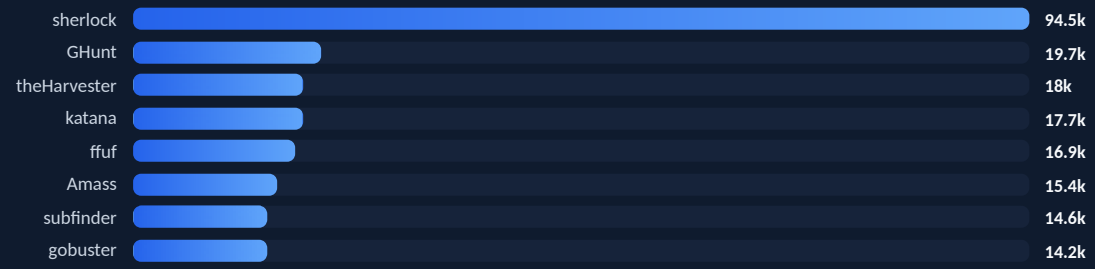
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the fingerprint database behind Metasploit and Nexpose: service banners mapped to OS and product families.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by fingerprinting tool maintainers for service identification; the open database behind Metasploit and Rapid7 tooling.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

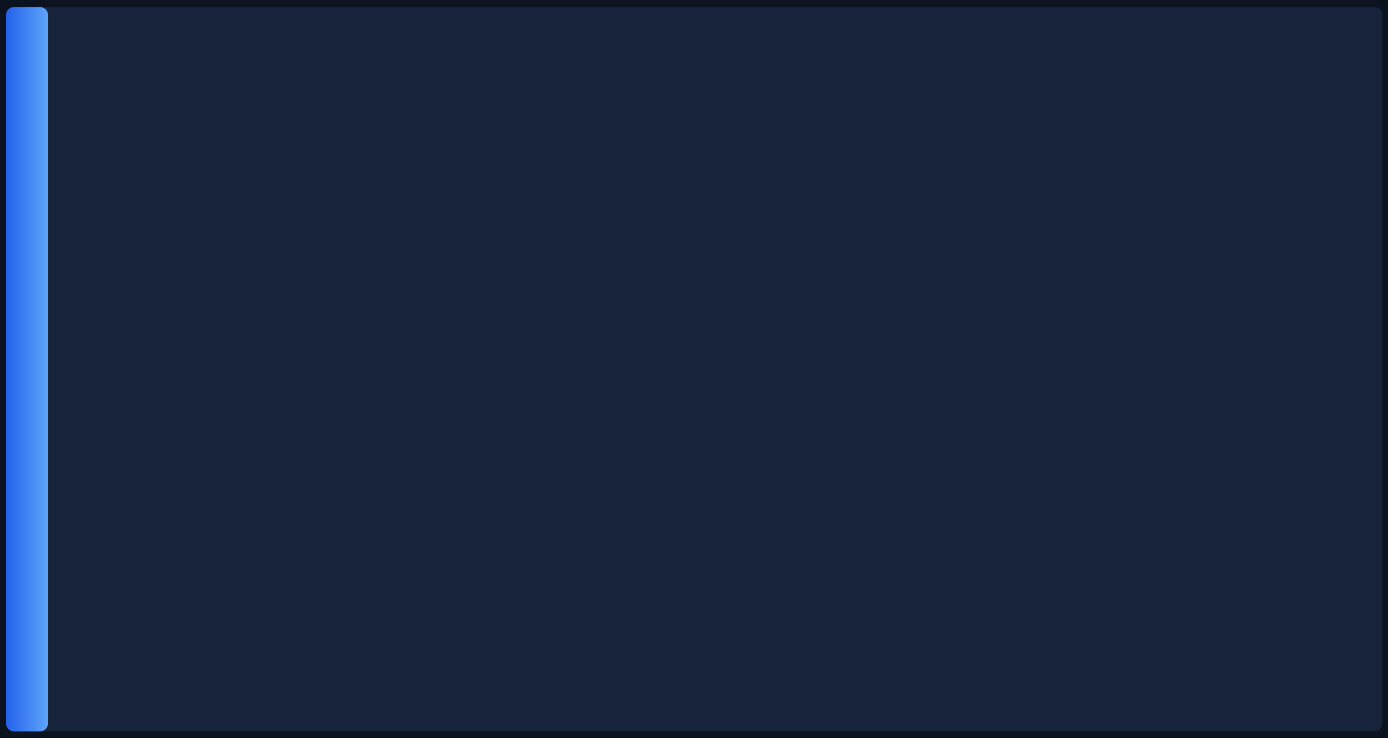


13	215	30	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

31 HASSH

github.com/salesforce/hassh

star weight vs realm #1



★ 554	GITHUB STARS
75	FORKS
2025-05	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
BSD-3-Clause	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"HASSH is a network fingerprinting standard which can be used to identify specific Client and Server SSH implementations. The fingerprints can be easily stored, searched and shared in the form of a small MD5 fingerprint."

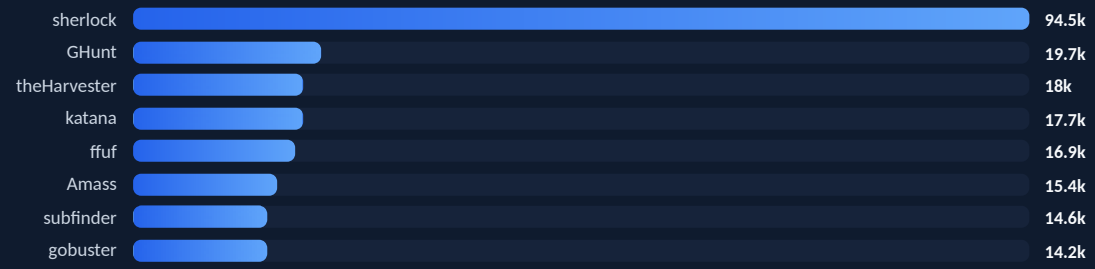
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

SSH key-exchange fingerprinting: identify client/server software from the KEX packet alone.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by threat hunters fingerprinting SSH clients and servers; the open fingerprinting standard for network telemetry.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

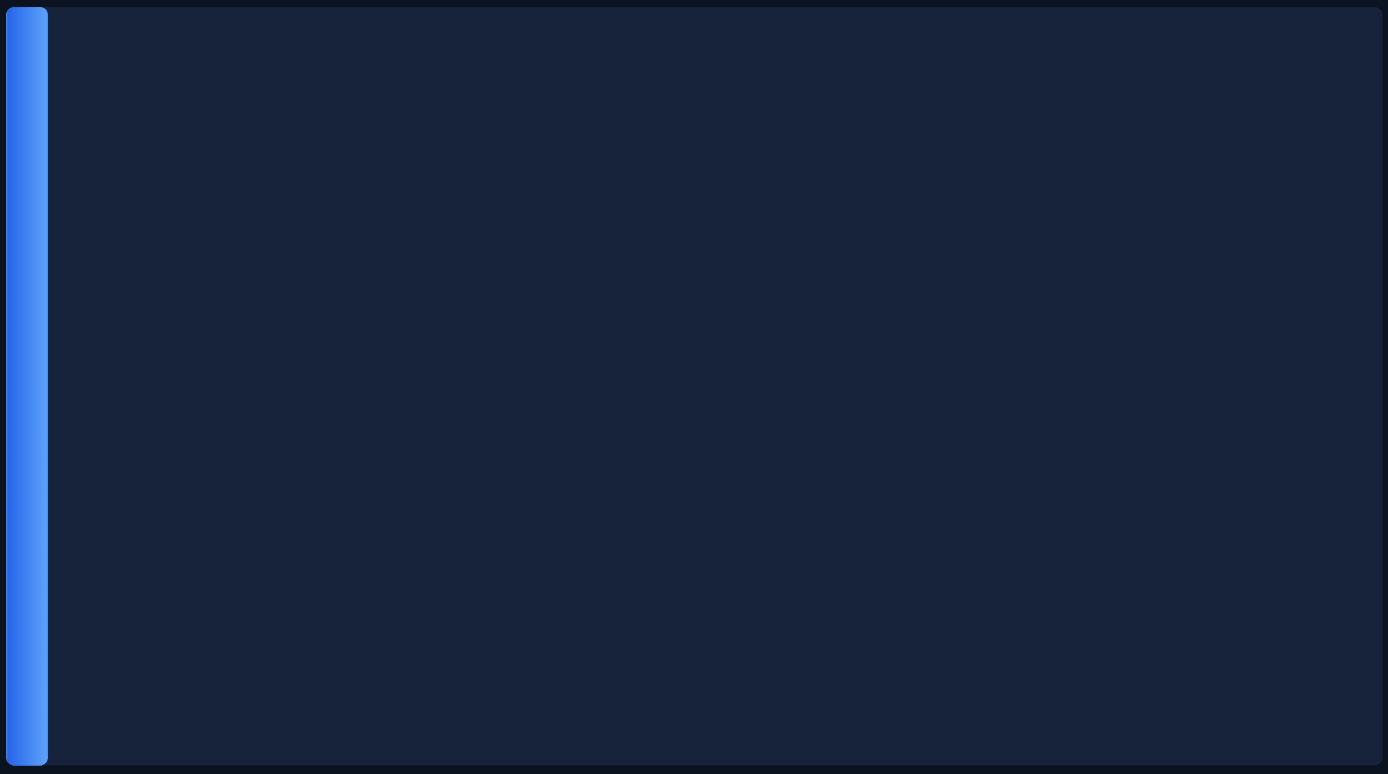


8	75	4	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

32 ike-scan

github.com/royhills/ike-scan

star weight vs realm #1



★ 423	GITHUB STARS
63	FORKS
2024-09	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The IKE Scanner"

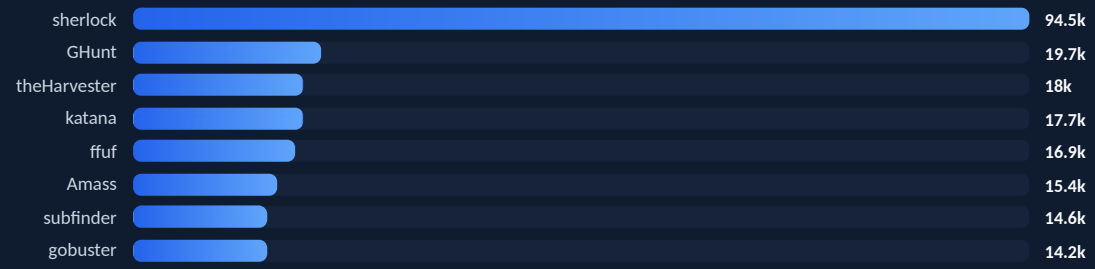
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

IKE/IPsec security auditing: fingerprint VPN gateways and enumerate transform proposals.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by network pentesters fingerprinting IKE/VPN endpoints; the classic free IPSec scanner.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



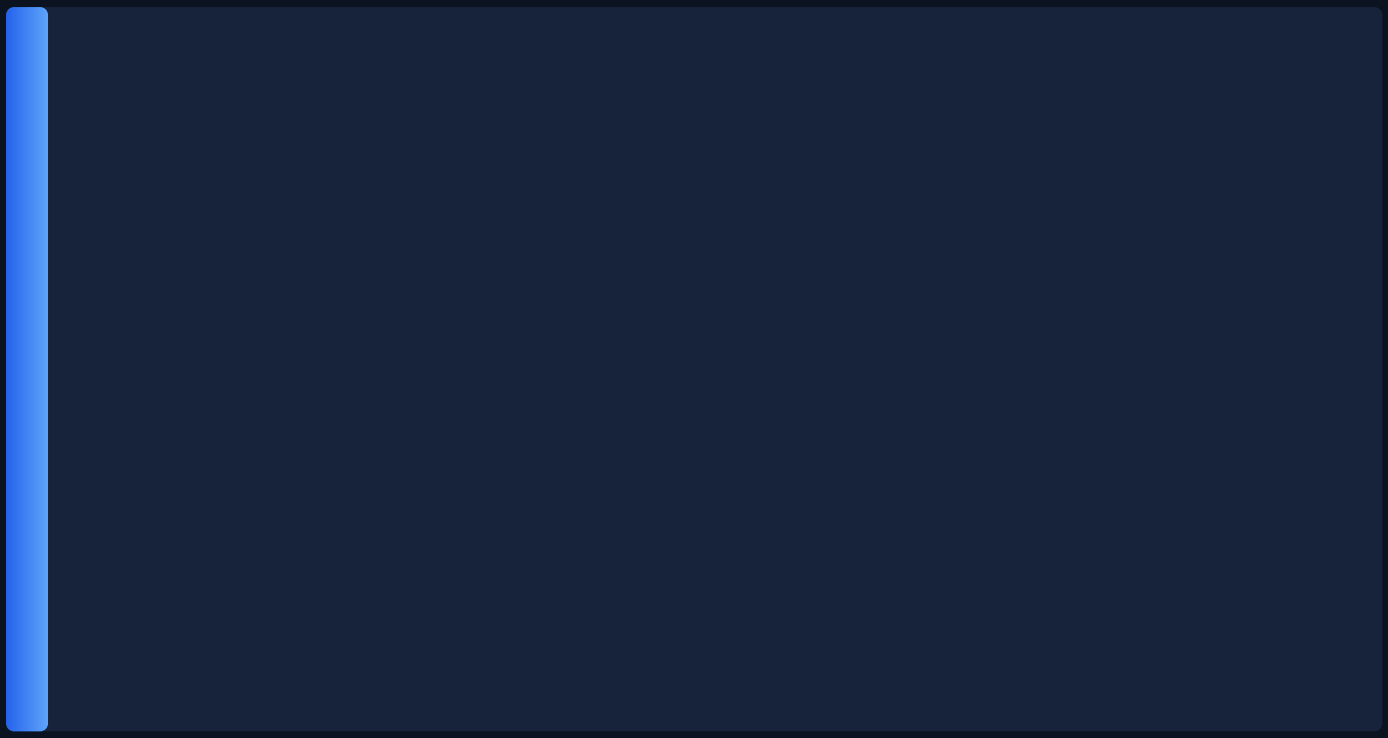
13 YEARS ON GITHUB	63 FORKS (REUSE)	23 OPEN ISSUES	— 2026 MOMENTUM

33 DorkEye

github.com/xPloits3c/DorkEye

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 153	GITHUB STARS
22	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2025	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Automated Google Dorking tool. It generates and executes advanced search queries to locate exposed files. It also checks for vulnerabilities such as SQLi and XSS, and performs metadata analysis and extraction."

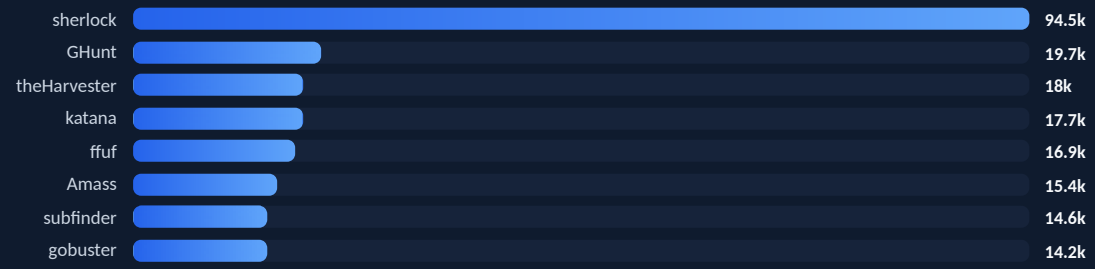
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

OSINT dork pipeline: email, subdomain and people discovery through structured query automation.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug hunters running Google dorks via SearX; the free web-based dork launcher.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



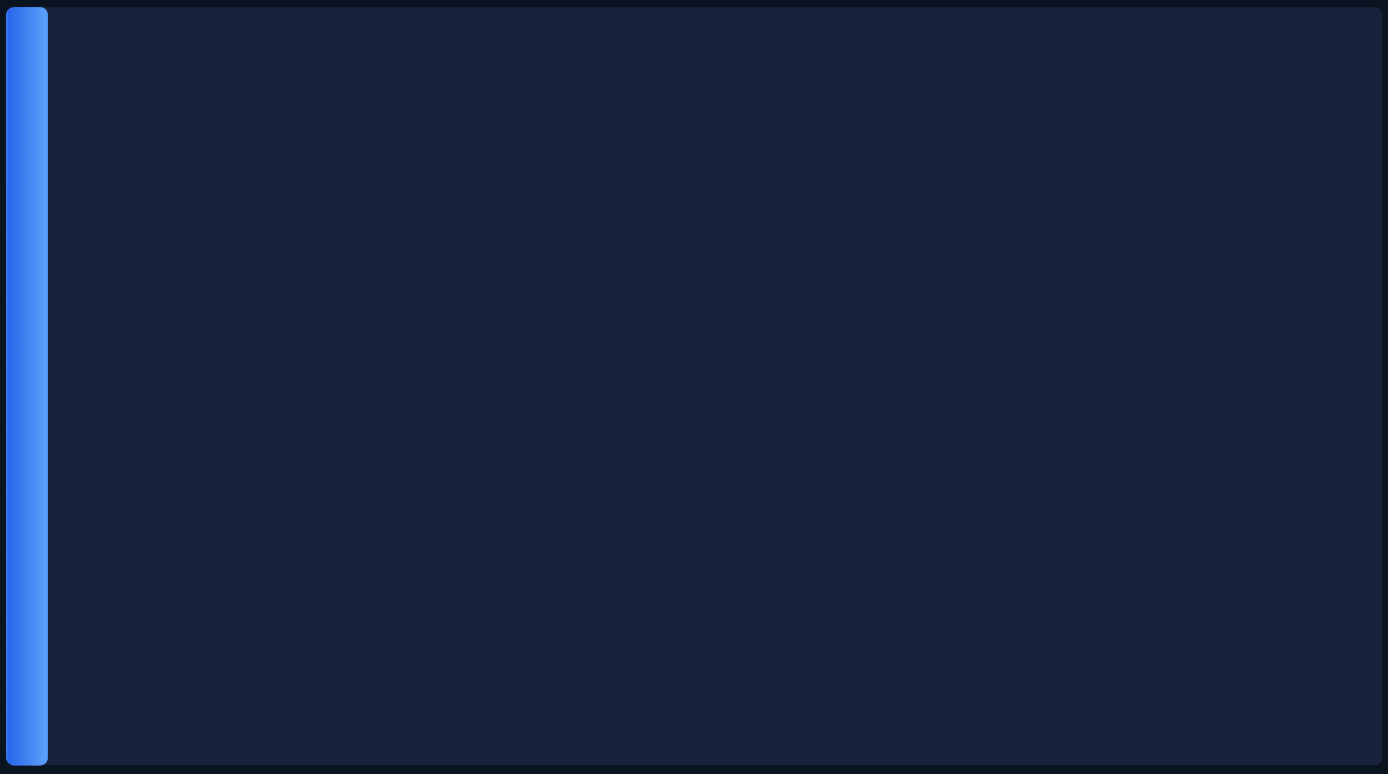
1	22	0	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

34 AtDork

github.com/amnottdevv/atdork

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 48	GITHUB STARS
10	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2026	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"tools auto dorking with multi enggine search"

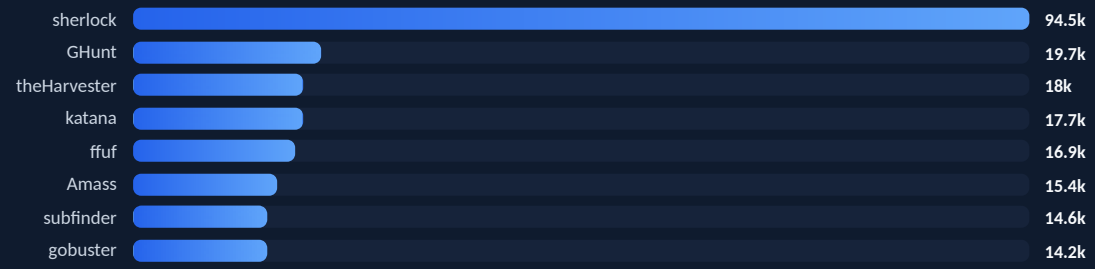
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

multi-engine Google-dork scraper with categorized GHDB output for authorized reconnaissance.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters automating Google dorking for exposed targets; the free dork engine for recon.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



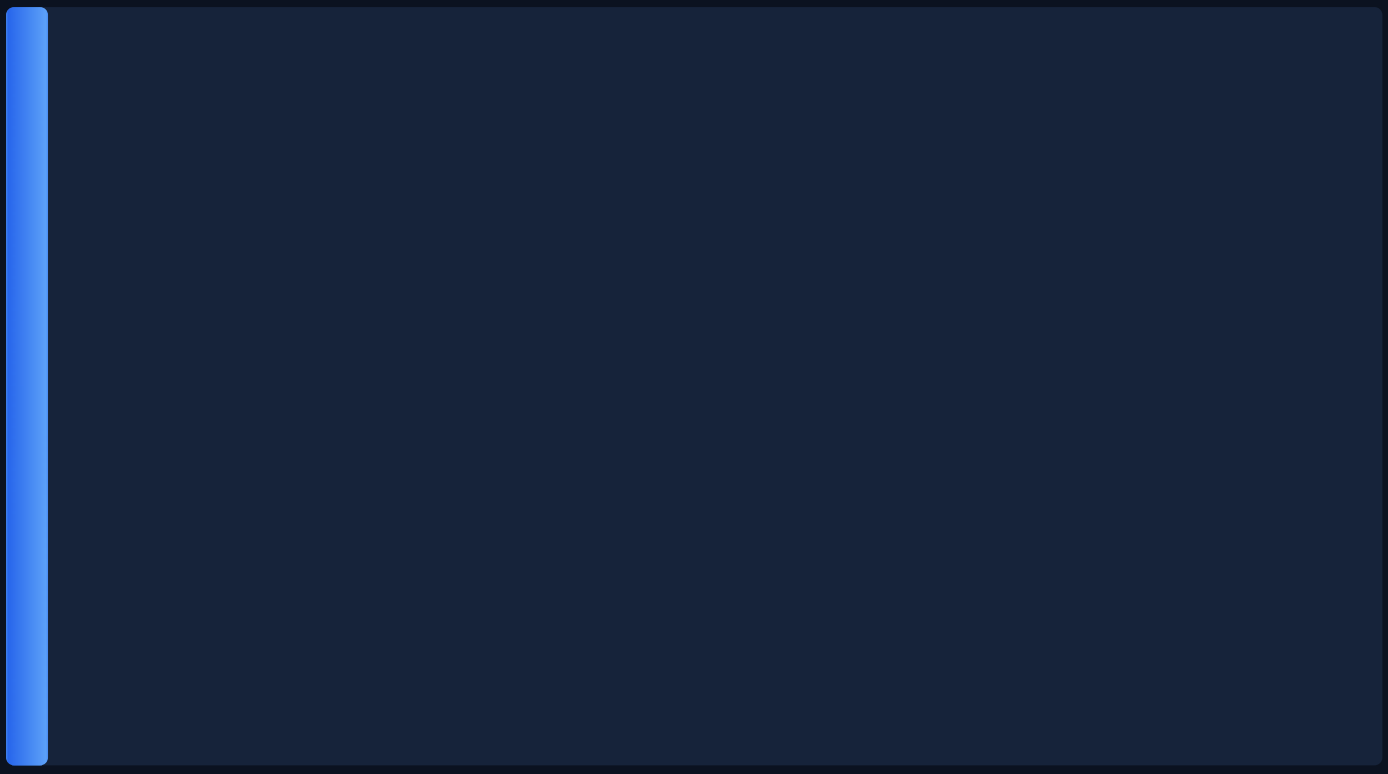
0	10	3	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

35 DorkCraft

github.com/juandresrodca/DorkCraft

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 9	GITHUB STARS
1	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2026	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Astro	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Google Dork helper"

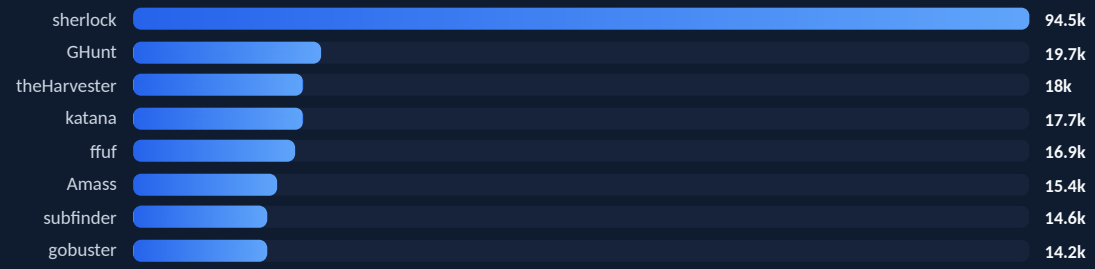
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

rule-based dork generator: translates intent into search queries deterministically, zero AI, zero outbound calls.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by recon practitioners bulk-running dork queries; the open dork-scanning alternative to paid search tooling.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



0	1	4	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

36 CeWL

digi.ninja/projects/cewl.php

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CeWL"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

custom wordlist generation by spidering target sites — the content-aware dictionary for authorized assessments.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters building custom wordlists from target sites for password audits; the standard free custom-wordlist spider.

37 DNSdump ster

dnsdumpster.com

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"DNSdumpster"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

visual DNS reconnaissance: subdomains, MX, and infrastructure maps from public records.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by beginners and quick-recon tasks for visual DNS mapping; the free web tool that kickstarts attack-surface discovery. (free service)

38 Maltego CE

www.maltego.com

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Maltego CE"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the standard OSINT graphing tool for entity-relationship investigation; free community edition.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by OSINT analysts and investigators for link analysis; the free community edition of the commercial Maltego. (free tier)

39 Merklemap

merklemap.com

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Merklemap”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

subdomain discovery through certificate-transparency logs; billions of entries, searchable.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by recon teams searching Certificate Transparency for subdomains; the free CT search joining crt.sh-style tooling. (free service)

40 WiGLE

wigle.net

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"WiGLE"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the wireless network mapping archive; queries by BSSID/SSID across millions of observed networks.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by wireless OSINT researchers mapping networks worldwide; the free wardriving database with no commercial equal. (free service)

04 Realm Directory

40 curated entries · A–Z

- Amass
- assetfinder
- AtDork
- Awesome Censys Queries
- bbot
- CeWL
- CloakQuest3r
- DNSdumpster
- dnsrecon
- dnstwist
- dnsx
- DorkCraft
- DorkEye
- EyeWitness
- feroxbuster
- ffuf
- FinalRecon
- gau
- GHunt
- gobuster
- HASSH
- httpx
- ike-scan
- JA3
- JARM
- katana
- Maltego CE
- massdns
- Merklemap
- naabu
- ParamSpider
- Recog
- recon-ng
- sherlock
- subfinder
- theHarvester
- VHostScan
- waymore
- wfuzz
- WiGLE